

TEEN SAFE

Technical Report - Admin Dashboard & Ad Management Portal



PREPARED BY

Design Think Tank
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Teen Safe lacked a centralized system to manage content moderation and advertising operations, leading to fragmented workflows, limited visibility, and inefficient decision-making.

To address this, conducted UX research using literature review, collaborative workshop activities, persona development, journey mapping, and heuristic evaluation to identify key usability gaps across moderation and campaign management workflows.

Based on these insights, the team redesigned and enhanced the original dashboard concepts to create an intuitive, scalable, and user-centered system. The solution streamlines moderation, introduces structured campaign management, and improves access to critical information, enabling faster, more informed decision-making.

Key improvements include:

- Clear information hierarchy for better visibility of alerts, user activity, and campaign performance
- Context-rich moderation tools with preview and policy support
- End-to-end ad management system for campaign creation, targeting, and performance tracking

This solution improves overall operational efficiency, enhances platform safety for teenage users, and provides a scalable foundation for future growth and monetization.

1. Project Overview

Teen Safe is a teen-focused social media platform that currently lacks a centralized system for managing content moderation and advertising operations.

The absence of structured administrative tools makes it difficult for internal teams to monitor user activity, enforce safety policies, and manage platform performance effectively. At the same time, the platform does not provide advertisers with a clear and effective way to create, manage, and evaluate campaigns, limiting its ability to support monetization and external partnerships.

Although the client provided initial design concepts for the admin dashboard; however, these designs were not production-ready and required further refinement. The goal of this project was to improve and create an intuitive, user-centered solution for administrators and advertisers.

1.1 Key Deliverables

- Admin Dashboard & Ad Management Portal
- User Personas
- User Journey Mapping
- Heuristic Evaluation Report
- New Visual Language (Recommendations)
- Low & High-fidelity Mockups & Prototypes

1.2 Problem Context

The primary problem is the absence of a structured administrative dashboard that supports content management, moderation of user activity, and oversight of system operations. This makes it difficult for internal teams to efficiently monitor activity, enforce safety policies, and ensure a safe environment for teenage users.

In addition, the platform needs improvement in its dedicated ad management portal for external businesses and advertisers. Advertisers do not have a clear, efficient way to create, manage, monitor, and evaluate advertising campaigns on the platform. This creates a limitation for the internal team's ability to support effective monetization, campaign transparency, and responsible advertising practices for a teenage audience.

These gaps create fragmented workflows, limited visibility, and inefficient decision-making across both moderation and advertising tasks. More importantly, they increase the risk of inconsistent moderation, delayed responses to harmful content, and exposure to inappropriate advertising.

Addressing these issues is essential to improving operational efficiency while ensuring strong user protection, safer content governance, and a trustworthy platform experience for teenage users.

1.3 Project Objective

The objective of this project is to design and optimize the user experience of the Teen Safe Admin Dashboard to effectively support multiple stakeholders, including moderators, advertisers, and platform managers.

Specifically, the project aims to:

- **Improve operational efficiency** by streamlining workflows, reducing cognitive load, and enabling faster, more accurate decision-making across moderation and advertising tasks.
- **Strengthen teen safety and user protection** through content moderation processes, improving policy support, and supporting responsible ad review and governance.
- **Enable effective advertising management** by improving advertising management tools, enabling more effective campaign performance, and fostering trust among advertisers through transparency and brand safety.
- **Support scalability and growth** by creating a flexible system that can evolve with an increasing user base, content volume, and advertisers' needs.

1.4 Employer Information

Teen Safe

Provided background on the admin dashboard and outlined what they hope for this project. Also provided essential information and strategic direction for the project.

2. Research Plan & Methodologies

2.1 Goals & Target Users

The goal of the research was to understand the needs, behaviors, and pain points of the platform's internal and external users to design an effective dashboard and ad management portal.

The research focused on three primary user groups:

- Platform Moderation Admins - responsible for reviewing content, enforcing policies, and ensuring a safe environment for teenage users.
- Digital Ad Managers - responsible for creating, managing, and optimizing advertising campaigns
- Ad Platform Success Managers - responsible for supporting advertisers, onboarding users, and ensuring successful campaign execution

The research aimed to:

- Map key workflows across moderation and advertising tasks
- Identify pain points in decision-making, data visibility, and system navigation
- Evaluate the usability of the dashboard design provided by the client
- Uncovering gaps and opportunities to improve the efficiency and usability of the existing system

A mixed-methods approach was taken, combining qualitative and quantitative techniques. This approach ensured that both user-centered insights and usability validation informed the design process.

2.2 Methods

To support the research objectives, a combination of exploratory and design-oriented methods were used. These methods aimed to gather insights from existing literature, capture user perspectives through collaborative activities, and explore visual directions for the interface design. Together, they informed both the functional and experiential aspects of the dashboard.

The following methods were used:

- Literature Review
- Workshop
- Design-oriented research(Color Palette Exploration / Color Palette Exploration / Logo Design)

2.2.1 Literature Review

Purpose: The purpose of the literature review was to establish a theoretical and contextual foundation for the project. It sought to synthesize existing research on teenage social media

behavior, targeted advertising, and content moderation, with a particular focus on ethical considerations and platform responsibilities.

Protocol: Relevant academic articles and industry reports were collected and analyzed. Key themes, including adolescent engagement with social media, advertising effectiveness, and moderation challenges, were identified and synthesized. Insights from the review informed persona development and defined system requirements.

Theme	Key Findings	Implications for Design
Teenagers as Valuable Users	Teenagers are highly active on social media and contribute significantly to platform revenue.	The system should support both user engagement and responsible management of teen users.
Data-Driven Advertising	Platforms use behavior data, usage habits, and interest tags to deliver targeted ads.	The dashboard should support clear audience targeting, tracking, and campaign optimization tools.
Ethical Concerns in Teen Advertising	Platforms must balance monetization with protecting teenagers from harmful or inappropriate content.	The system should include strong moderation, ad review, and content control mechanisms.
High Teen Engagement with Brands	Over 70% of teens interact with brands, and many follow multiple brands.	There is significant potential for advertising features, which require effective campaign management tools.
Limited Advertising Literacy	Teenagers often do not understand how ads are targeted or how to control their data.	The platform should ensure transparency and enforce stricter ad governance and safety policies.
Need for Moderation and Control	Platforms require age restrictions, ad review processes, and sensitive content filtering.	The dashboard must include efficient moderation workflows and safety-focused features.

Table 2.1 Literature Review Summary Table

2.2.2 Collaborative Workshop

Purpose: The workshop aimed to gather user-centered insights by exploring stakeholder perspectives, including those of moderators, advertisers, and platform support roles. It focused on understanding workflows, identifying pain points, and mapping user journeys in the admin dashboard.

Protocol: Collaborative workshop sessions were conducted through structured activities, including persona creation and journey mapping. Participants contributed ideas through discussions and Affinity Mapping exercises, and the ideas were later grouped and analyzed to identify patterns, key tasks, and opportunities for improvement.

Brainstorming

200,000 Active users that use
the platform on a daily basis

Teenagers 12- 17 years of age

Boys and Girls

Social activities
events that get hosted thru the platform

Admin - Hasnain

Account manager - Devi

LIT Teen Social

Ad management platform

ACME SHOE COMPANY

LOGIN - ACME

Password - ACME



Figure 2.1 Workshop Login Page Ideation

ACME SHOES COMPANY

Shoe Brand Company

- Just started off
- Need sales and attract customers
- 1-year
- 2 million

Specialize in Boys and Girls

- Fashionable, workout, active lifestyle, sports
- 12 - 17 ages (teenagers)
- Leather, vinyl
- provides shoes that are reasonably priced and good quality versus other shoes in the same segment of the market
- Word of mouth
- Advertisement
 - ~~brand endorsement by influencers~~
 - Social media ads
 - flyers/poster
 - near school
 - outside schools
 - give to students/parents
 - playgrounds
 - malls/shopping center
 - one-day camps
 - bus stops/public transport
- Short video
 - social media
- Events/at a fair
 - merchandising
- webinar
 - talking about fashion
 - parents/fun for teenagers
 - online event
- collaboration with different brands
 - complimentary space

Posting guidelines

review process

- by admin
 - by owner
- #### Customization
- based on gender



how large image

how it shows on the platform
images (more than 1)

How many words you can

type

can i upload a video/picture

what else can you add to the page

price or link

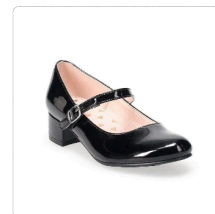
features or link

Call to action button

layout (live preview as you see on mobile)

any template

metrics/analytics



girl - 12/13 years
casual wear
super comfortable
\$20
leather

Figure 2.2 Merchant Background

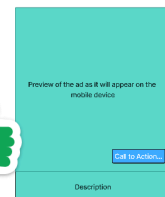
ACME shoe company



Create a new campaign

Name of the campaign
Description
Call to Action button
age
gender
Their interests/hobbies
Campaign budget
Duration of the ad - start/end

Image upload
you can gif, video, jpeg 2mb maximum



Save to draft

Publish

0000 00:00 review

Figure 2.3 Ad Setup Process -1

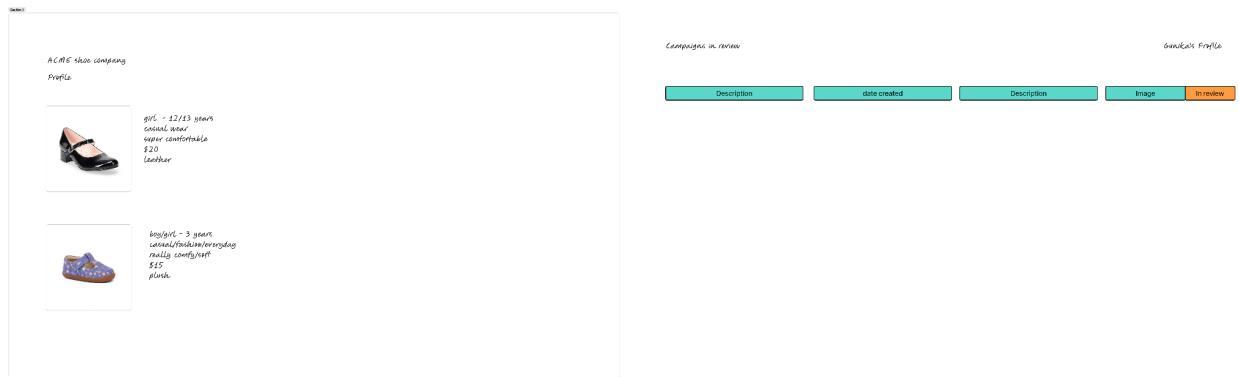


Figure 2.3 Ad Setup Process -2

2.2.3 Design-oriented research

Purpose: The purpose of design-oriented research was to translate user insights into visual and experiential design directions. It sought to explore how the interface could convey clarity, trust, and usability while aligning with a youth-focused platform.

Protocol: Mood boards and color palette explorations were developed to define the dashboard's visual language. Multiple visual styles were evaluated against criteria including readability, accessibility, and emotional tone. The selected direction then guided the interface design and ensured consistency across the system.

2.3 Project Structure and Workflow

To manage the research and design process effectively, structured the work around a set of clearly defined deliverables aligned with key stages of the UX process, from initial planning through research, the workshop, and final reporting. Each deliverable had specific objectives and timelines, and each member was responsible for coordination, communication, and quality assurance. Leads ensured that deliverables remained on track and aligned with project goals, while task execution was carried out collaboratively by all team members.

2.3.1 Overview of Major Deliverables

The table below outlines the major deliverables produced throughout the project. Each deliverable played a distinct role in shaping the research and design outcomes, contributing to both formative understanding and tangible outputs.

Major Deliverables	Description	Timeline
Research Plan	Define research goals, scope, target users, and methods, including literature review, design-oriented research, and workshop.	2/23-2/27
Literature Review	Review academic and	3/16-3/20

	industry sources to identify key insights on teenage users, advertising, and content moderation.	
Design-oriented Research	Explore visual design directions through mood boards and color palettes to define a consistent and user-friendly interface.	3/23-3/27
Collaborative Workshop	Conduct collaborative sessions to identify user roles, workflows, and pain points through persona and journey mapping activities.	3/30-4/3
Personas (*3)	Create three personas representing different roles based on the literature review and workshop insight.	4/6-4/10
Journey Map	Develop a journey map for three roles that may use the admin dashboard, including their pain points and goals.	4/6-4/10
Prototype	Design Low- and high-fidelity prototypes based on our research and discussion	4/13-4/24
Project Summary & Timeline	Summarize the project scope, goals, and deliverable timeline; include team responsibilities.	4/13-4/24
Usability Testing Plan	Evaluate the effectiveness and usability of the dashboard through user testing to identify issues and improve overall user experience.	4/13-4/24
Technical Report	Summarize findings from the literature review, highlight issues, and provide actionable UX recommendations.	4/24-5/1

Final Presentation	Present the design process, key insights, and final solution to communicate the project outcomes to the professor and Tami.	5/7
Progress Update & Employer Messages	Provide an honest update to Tami on project status, including achievements, blockers, and next steps.	N/A
Meeting Notes	Notes about meeting date, context, and attendees.	N/A

Table 2.2 Major Deliverables with Descriptions

3. Literature Review & Workshop

3.1 Key Insights from Literature

Based on the reviewed academic articles and industry sources, the following key insights were identified:

3.1.1 Teenagers as High-Value Users in Social Media Ecosystems

- Teenagers (ages 12–17) represent a significant portion of social media users and contribute heavily to platform engagement.
- Platforms rely on teenagers' **high usage frequency and interaction levels** to drive advertising revenue.
- A large percentage of platform income is directly linked to this demographic.

Teenagers are not only users but also a **primary driver of platform monetization**, making them a critical focus for both design and business strategy.

3.1.2 Effectiveness of Targeted Advertising Driven by User Data

- Social media platforms leverage:
 - behavioral data
 - usage habits
 - interest tagging

to deliver highly personalized advertisements.

- Targeted ads increase engagement and conversion rates, making them highly valuable for advertisers.

Effective advertising systems depend on **data-driven targeting**, requiring dashboards that support segmentation, tracking, and optimization.

3.1.3 Ethical Challenges in Advertising to Teenagers

- Teen users often have **limited awareness of how ads are targeted**.
- Many cannot:
 - understand data usage
 - evaluate ad appropriateness
 - manage privacy settings
- Advertising literacy typically develops only after age 16+.

Platforms must implement **responsible and transparent advertising systems**, especially when targeting minors.

3.1.4 Need for Strong Content Moderation and Governance

- Platforms must balance:
 - **revenue generation (ads)**
 - **user safety (especially minors)**
- Key moderation requirements identified include:
 - ad review processes
 - age restrictions
 - sensitive content filtering

Moderation plays a central role in maintaining trust and platform integrity. Robust moderation systems are essential to ensure **safe, compliant, and trustworthy user experiences**.

3.1.5 High Engagement Between Teenagers and Brands

- Over **70% of teenagers interact with brands** on social media.
- Around **35% actively follow multiple brands**.
- Social media acts as a major channel for brand discovery and engagement.

There is strong potential for **advertising growth**, provided the platform supports effective campaign management and targeting.

3.1.6 Need to Balance Safety and Monetization

- Platforms face ongoing tension between:
 - maximizing ad revenue
 - protecting teenage users

- Poorly managed advertising or content can erode user trust and the platform's reputation.

Design decisions must support a **balance between business objectives and ethical responsibility**, rather than prioritizing one over the other.

3.2 Key Insights from Workshop

Based on the workshop activities, including brainstorming, sticky note clustering, and early wireframe exploration (as shown in Figures 2.1-2.4), several key insights were identified:

3.2.1 Fragmented and Complex Admin Workflows

- Workshop participants identified multiple disconnected functions, such as **alerts/issues, user management, advertiser management, and policy documentation**.
- Tasks such as **content moderation, age verification, and ad review** are currently handled across separate sections without a unified flow.
- This fragmentation increases cognitive load and slows down task completion.

3.2.2 High Demand for Clear Data Visibility

- Sticky notes highlighted key dashboard needs such as:
 - number of active users
 - alerts/issues per month
 - ad revenue and performance
 - user activity tracking

Current concepts lack a clear hierarchy for presenting this information.

3.2.3 Critical Importance of Safety and Moderation Tools

- Workshop outputs emphasized features such as:
 - **age verification (age check)**
 - **reporting inappropriate posts**
 - **reviewing flagged content**

Moderation was identified as a core responsibility, especially given the teenage user base.

3.2.4 Need for Efficient Ad Campaign Creation and Management

- Brainstorming around advertiser needs included:
 - creating, managing, and duplicating campaigns
 - uploading media (images/videos)
 - defining targeting (age, gender, interests)
 - setting budget and duration

The workflow also includes **review/approval stages before publishing**.

3.2.5 Importance of Real-Time Preview and Feedback

- Workshop sketches included features such as:
 - **live preview of ads on mobile devices**
 - ability to see layout and content before publishing

Users expressed uncertainty about how ads would appear after deployment.

3.2.6 Need for Status Tracking and Workflow Transparency

- Campaign states such as:
 - in review
 - active
 - draft

were explicitly identified in workshop artifacts. However, transitions between these states were not clearly defined.

3.2.7 Desire for Customization and Flexibility

- Workshop notes and layouts showed the need for:
 - filtering campaigns or content
 - customizing views
 - adjusting displayed information

3.2.8 Lack of Guidance and Policy Clarity

- Notes related to **policy documentation and guidelines** indicate that users often rely on external references.
- Decision-making (especially moderation) lacks built-in support.

3.3 Synthesis of Findings

By combining insights from the literature review and the workshop, several overarching themes emerged.

First, **decision-making uncertainty** is a shared challenge across all user roles. Whether moderating content or managing campaigns, users often lack the context or guidance to make confident decisions.

Second, there is a strong need for **transparency and clarity**, particularly when interpreting policy, analyzing data, and providing system feedback.

Third, the findings underscore the need to **balance safety and monetization**. While advertising is essential to platform sustainability, it must be carefully managed to avoid compromising the safety and well-being of teenage users.

Finally, the results underscore the need for **efficient and scalable workflows**. As the platform scales, tools must support high-volume tasks while maintaining accuracy and usability.

These insights directly informed the design direction of the admin dashboard and advertising management portal, guiding decisions on information hierarchy, interaction design, and system functionality.

4. UX Artifacts & Design Deliverables

4.1 Persona

4.1.1 Persona Development Objectives

The goal of persona development for the Teen Safe Admin Dashboard is to ground the design process in real user needs and behaviours, including different roles that may have to use the admin dashboard, including platform moderation admin for Teen Social, Digital Ad manager for a company that manufactures items for teenagers, and an Ad platform success manager for the same company. From the literature review and workshop, the aim was to:

- **Identify key user roles and responsibilities** within the admin ecosystem, including moderators, advertisers, and platform support teams, and understand how their goals may conflict or align.
- **Understand decision-making challenges in content moderation**, especially under high-volume, policy-ambiguous conditions, to support faster, more consistent review workflows.
- **Explore the balance between platform safety and revenue generation**, particularly in the context of targeted advertising toward teenagers, where ethical considerations and business goals may conflict.
- **Capture pain points in ad campaign management**, such as unclear audience insights, limited budget control, and a lack of transparency in performance metrics.
- **Identify gaps in current moderation and advertising tools**, including a lack of contextual information, complex workflows, and insufficient policy guidance.
- **Understand the need for age-appropriate content governance**, including ad review mechanisms, age restrictions, and filtering of sensitive content for teenage users.
- **Highlight the importance of transparency and trust** for both internal users (moderators, managers) and external stakeholders (advertisers), especially on a platform targeting minors.
- **Translate user needs into system requirements**, such as:
 - clear policy guidelines
 - streamlined review workflows
 - intuitive campaign setup tools
 - accessible analytics dashboards

4.1.2 Summary of Three Personas: Background, Goals, Pain Points

Persona 1: Platform Moderation Admin (Jordan)

Background: Serves as a moderation admin for a teen-focused social platform, handling large volumes of flagged content daily. Responsible for enforcing policies, verifying user age, and maintaining platform safety.

Goals: Ensure all ads and content are age-appropriate and comply with platform policies. Improve review efficiency while maintaining accuracy in high-pressure environments.

Frustrations: Struggles with unclear or ambiguous ad policies, especially in edge cases. Faces a high workload and lacks sufficient context when making moderation decisions.

Persona 2: Digital Ad Manager (Emily)

Background: An experienced digital advertising manager working in a budget-conscious startup targeting teenage audiences. Uses platforms like TikTok and Instagram to analyze trends and optimize campaigns.

Goals: Reach the right teen audience effectively while maximizing campaign performance within a limited budget. Access clear and actionable data to quickly evaluate campaign success.

Frustrations: Finds it difficult to interpret unclear audience data and performance metrics. Limited control over targeting and rising ad costs reduce campaign efficiency.

Persona 3: Ad Platform Success Manager (Jane)

Background: Works closely with advertisers to help them use the platform effectively and understand its value. Supports onboarding, campaign setup, and ongoing performance monitoring.

Goals: Help advertisers launch successful campaigns and build trust in the platform. Ensure users can easily understand tools and achieve effective audience targeting.

Frustrations: Users often compare the platform to larger competitors and hesitate to trust it. Many require extensive support due to the complex setup and unclear targeting options.

4.1.3 Persona Visual



About

Jordan is a Platform Moderation Admin with 5–7 years of experience, responsible for overseeing content moderation on a social media platform designed for teenage users. He manages moderation workflows for a single platform, ensuring that all content and users meet age requirements and community guidelines.

In his day-to-day work, Jordan reviews flagged posts, verifies user age when necessary, and supports consistent enforcement of platform policies. He also monitors moderation quality and relies on clear guidelines and efficient tools to handle high volumes of user-generated content.

Jordan values systems that reduce ambiguity, streamline verification processes, and support accurate decision-making at scale. He is particularly focused on maintaining a safe, age-appropriate environment, knowing that moderation decisions directly impact user trust and platform integrity.

Goals

- Keep ads safe and age-appropriate
- Review ads quickly and accurately
- Handle edge cases with confidence
- Support a trustworthy platform experience

Frustrations

- Unclear ad policies
- High volume of ads to review
- Repeated policy violations
- Not enough context for difficult cases
- Balancing safety with business goals

Motivations

- Creating a safer experience for teen users
- Upholding ethical advertising standards
- Catching harmful content before it goes live
- Helping maintain trust in the platform

Needs

- Clear policy guidelines
- Simple review and escalation workflow
- More context during ad review
- Better moderation tools
- Strong coordination with Ops and Support

Favourite apps

Medium Twitch Instagram

Figure 4.1 Persona 1 – Jordan



About

Emily is a digital advertising manager with 10 years of experience working in fast-paced, budget-conscious environments. She currently works at a startup teen fashion shoe company, where she is responsible for maximizing campaign performance with limited resources. Emily regularly uses platforms like TikTok and Instagram to track trends, analyze competitor strategies, and identify cost-effective ways to reach teenage audiences.

She is highly data-driven and values quick feedback loops, often needing to assess campaign performance within the first 24–48 hours. Emily prioritizes platforms that offer clear audience targeting, transparent ad performance metrics, and brand-safe environments, as she is mindful of how advertising influences younger audiences.

Goals

- Understand the platform's value for teen marketing
- Reach the right teen audience effectively
- Run cost-effective campaigns
- Protect brand safety and campaign quality

Frustrations

- Limited budget and rising ad costs
- Unclear audience and performance data
- Complex or unfamiliar ad tools
- Limited control over targeting and placement
- Concerns about brand safety and trust

Motivations

- Make a strong impact with a small budget
- Understand teen trends and behaviour
- Build a relatable, trusted brand
- Improve campaign performance over time

Needs

- Clear audience insights
- Simple campaign setup and management
- Transparent targeting and placement options
- Easy-to-read performance analytics
- Confidence in brand-safe advertising

Favourite apps



Figure 4.2 Persona 2 – Emily



About

Jane is an Ad Platform Success Manager at a teen social platform company. She works closely with advertisers who want to connect with a niche audience of teens aged 12 to 17 through the company's ad manager platform. Her role is to help customers understand the platform's value, guide them through campaign setup, and support them in targeting the right audience effectively. She also helps ensure that campaigns align with platform policies and brand safety expectations while giving customers confidence in using a newer, less familiar advertising tool.

In her day-to-day work, Jane answers customer questions, reviews campaign details, helps troubleshoot setup issues, and supports advertisers in understanding campaign performance once ads go live. Because many customers are comparing the platform to larger ad networks, she needs the experience to feel simple, trustworthy, and easy to learn. Her success depends on helping customers see the platform as a credible and effective way to reach a teen audience.

Goals

- Help advertisers launch effective campaigns
- Increase adoption of the ad manager
- Build trust in the platform
- Support strong audience targeting.

Frustrations

- Customers compare the platform to larger networks
- Struggle to understand targeting options
- Hesitate to trust a newer platform
- Need too much support during setup.

Motivations

- Deliver high-quality campaigns
- Build confidence in her decision making skills
- Contribute to better campaign performance and results
- Gain recognition for efficiency

Needs

- Clear onboarding
- Simple campaign setup flow
- Easy-to-understand targeting tools
- Transparent performance metrics
- Helpful guidance and education.

Favourite apps



Figure 4.3 Persona 3 – Jane

4.2 User Flow Journey

4.2.1 Structure of User Flow and Emotional Journey

Persona 1: Platform Moderation Admin (Jordan)

User Flow: Jordan begins by reviewing flagged content to assess the workload and prioritize cases by risk level. He then reviews individual content items, verifies context (e.g., user age, policy relevance), and makes moderation decisions, including approving, rejecting, or escalating cases. Finally, he monitors outcomes to ensure consistency and moderation quality over time.

Emotional Journey: At first, Jordan feels neutral but quickly becomes overwhelmed by the high volume of content. During the prioritization and review stages, frustration rises when policies are unclear or the context is insufficient. Confidence improves slightly when decisions are clear, but uncertainty remains in edge cases. Over time, repeated exposure to ambiguous cases can lead to fatigue, though effective tools and clear workflows can help restore a sense of control and confidence.

Persona 2: Digital Ad Manager (Emily)

User Flow: Emily begins by analyzing campaign performance and audience insights to assess current effectiveness. She then adjusts targeting strategies, budget allocation, and ad creatives to optimize performance. During the review stage, she evaluates campaign metrics and compares results across platforms before deciding to scale, pause, or refine campaigns. Finally, she monitors performance trends to inform future strategies.

Emotional Journey: Emily initially feels focused and goal-driven, but becomes uncertain when data is unclear or lacks transparency. Frustration arises when tools are complex or when she cannot clearly identify why a campaign is underperforming. Confidence increases when insights are actionable and easy to interpret, but fluctuates with budget constraints and external factors. Overall, her emotional state depends heavily on the clarity and reliability of data.

Persona 3: Ad Platform Success Manager (Jane)

User Flow: Jane begins by onboarding advertisers and helping them understand the platform's value and capabilities. She guides users through campaign setup, including audience targeting and ad configuration. During the review phase, she supports troubleshooting and explains campaign performance. She then assists with decision-making and optimization, and finally monitors user success and satisfaction to ensure long-term platform adoption.

Emotional Journey: Jane starts with a supportive, proactive mindset but may feel pressure when users struggle to understand the system. Frustration arises when advertisers compare the platform to more established competitors or repeatedly request assistance. Satisfaction increases when users successfully launch campaigns and gain confidence in the platform. However, ongoing reliance on support can cause stress if the tools are not intuitive enough.

4.2.2 Key Quotes and User Actions at Each Stage

Persona 1: Platform Moderation Admin (Jordan)

	User Actions	Key Quotes
Overview	- Logs into the dashboard and scans the flagged content queue - Checks workload and identifies urgent cases	"There's already too much to go through." "I need to quickly understand what's most urgent."
Prioritize	- Filters content based on risk level and category - Flags high-risk or unclear cases for deeper review	"Which of these could cause the most harm?" "I don't have time to check everything in detail."
Review	- Reviews content details, user info, and context - Cross-checks with policy	"This doesn't clearly violate the rules, but it feels wrong." "I wish I had more context before"

	guidelines	deciding.”
Decide & Act	- Approves, rejects, or escalates content - Documents decisions when necessary	“I hope this decision aligns with policy.” “If I’m wrong, it could impact users.”
Monitor	- Tracks moderation outcomes and feedback - Reviews flagged errors or inconsistencies	“Am I being consistent across decisions?” “There should be a better way to track quality.”

Persona 2: Digital Ad Manager (Emily)

	User Actions	Key Quotes
Overview	- Reviews the dashboard for campaign performance - Checks key metrics (reach, engagement, cost)	“How are my campaigns performing right now?” “I need a quick overview before making changes.”
Prioritize	- Identifies underperforming campaigns - Allocates budget to high-performing segments	“Which campaign needs my attention first?” “I can’t waste budget on low-performing ads.”
Review	- Analyzes audience insights and engagement data - Compares performance across channels	“Why is this campaign not working?” “The data isn’t clear enough to act on.”
Decide & Act	- Adjusts targeting, creatives, or budget - Launches or pauses campaigns	“I’ll try adjusting the audience and see what happens.” “This is a risk, but I need to optimize fast.”
Monitor	- Tracks performance trends over time - Evaluates ROI and campaign effectiveness	“Is this actually improving performance?” “I need clearer insights to justify decisions.”

Persona 3: Ad Platform Success Manager (Jane)

	User Actions	Key Quotes
Overview	- Reviews client accounts and onboarding status - Prepares to assist users with setup	"Do they understand how this platform works?" "I need to guide them from the start."
Prioritize	- Identifies clients who need immediate support - Focuses on accounts struggling with setup	"Who is stuck and needs help right now?" "Some users need more guidance than others."
Review	- Checks campaign setup and targeting configurations - Reviews user questions and issues	"They're confused about targeting options." "The system isn't as intuitive as it should be."
Decide & Act	- Provides recommendations and troubleshooting support - Guides users through campaign adjustments	"Let me show you how to fix this." "If they succeed, they'll trust the platform."
Monitor	- Tracks client success and adoption - Collects feedback for improvement	"Are they continuing to use the platform?" "Need to improve this experience long-term."

4.2.3 Final Journey Map Visual

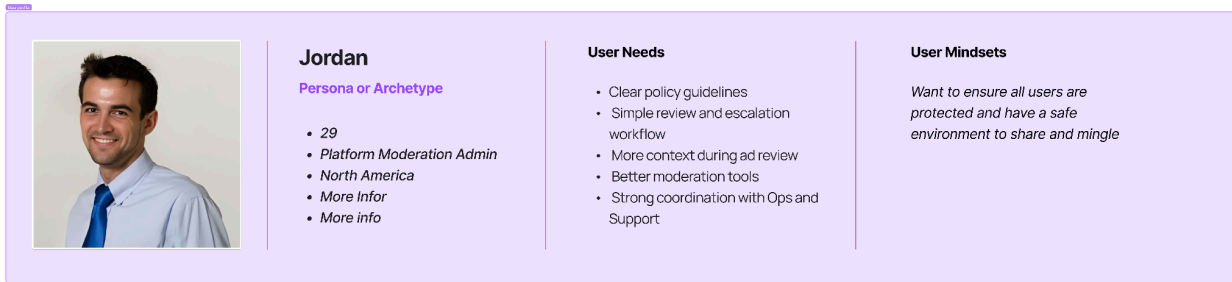


Figure 4.4 User Journey Flow – Jordan -1

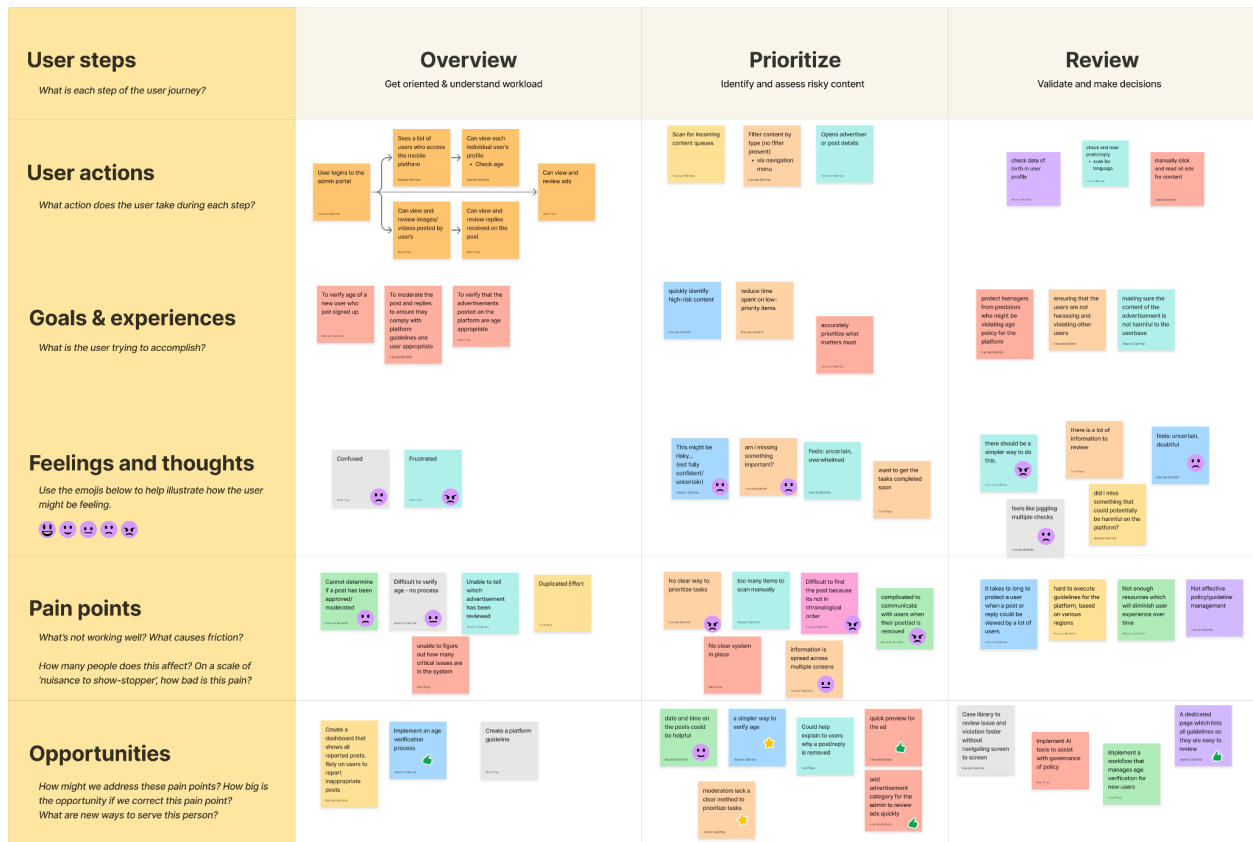


Figure 4.4 User Journey Flow – Jordan -2

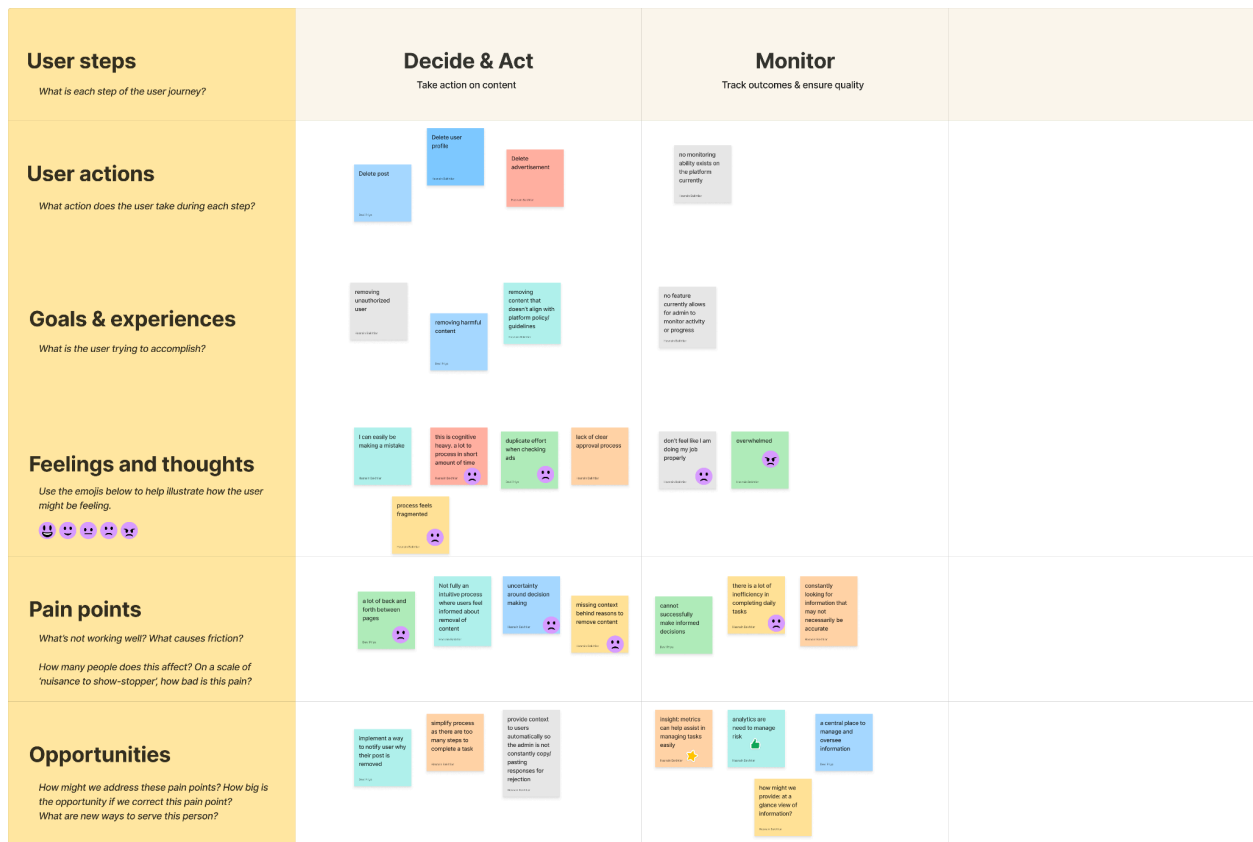


Figure 4.4 User Journey Flow – Jordan -3

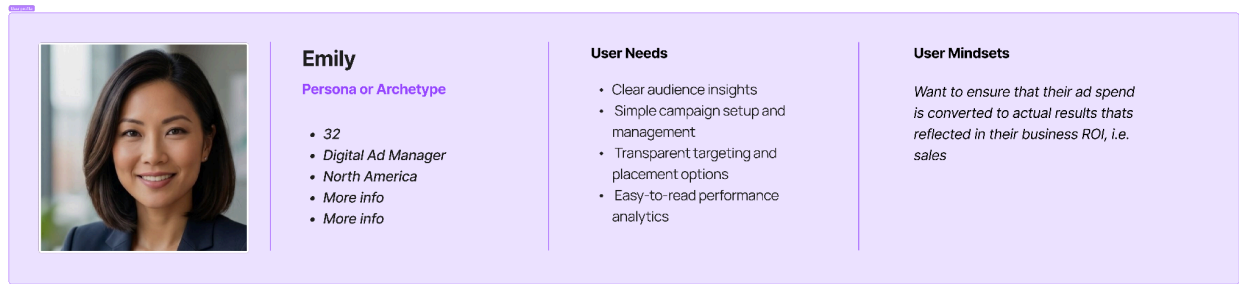


Figure 4.5 User Journey Flow – Emily -1

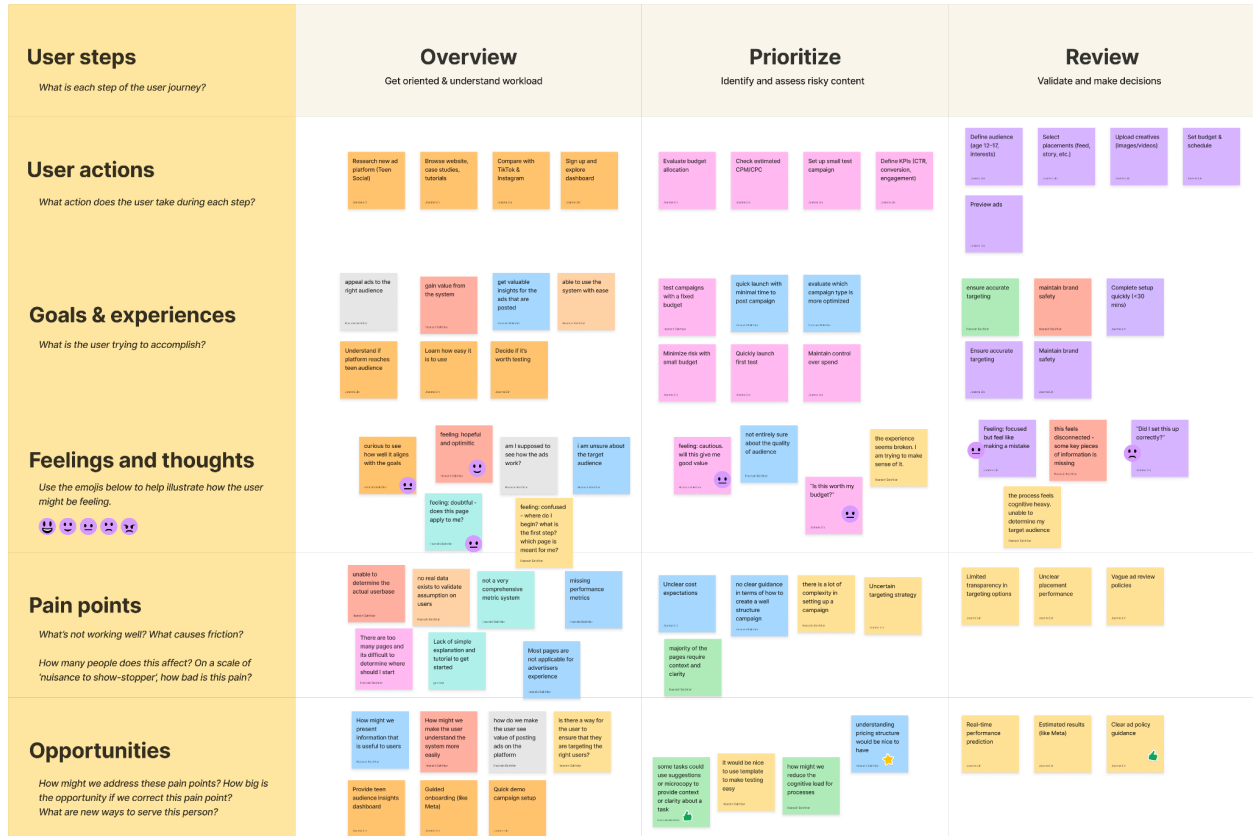


Figure 4.5 User Journey Flow – Emily -2

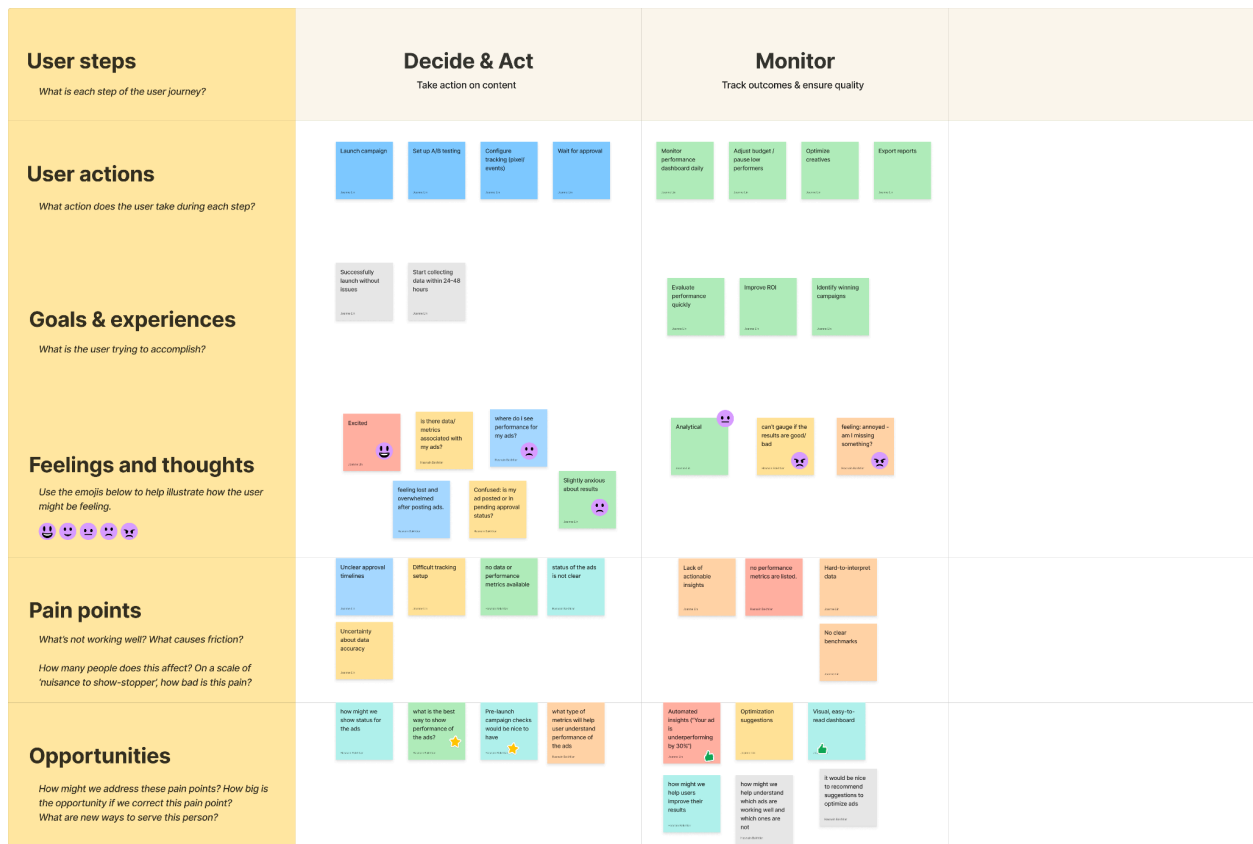


Figure 4.5 User Journey Flow – Emily -3

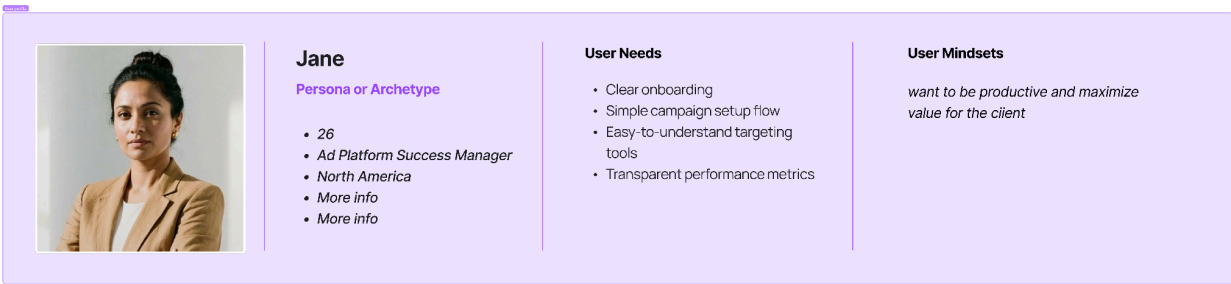


Figure 4.6 User Journey Flow – Jane -1

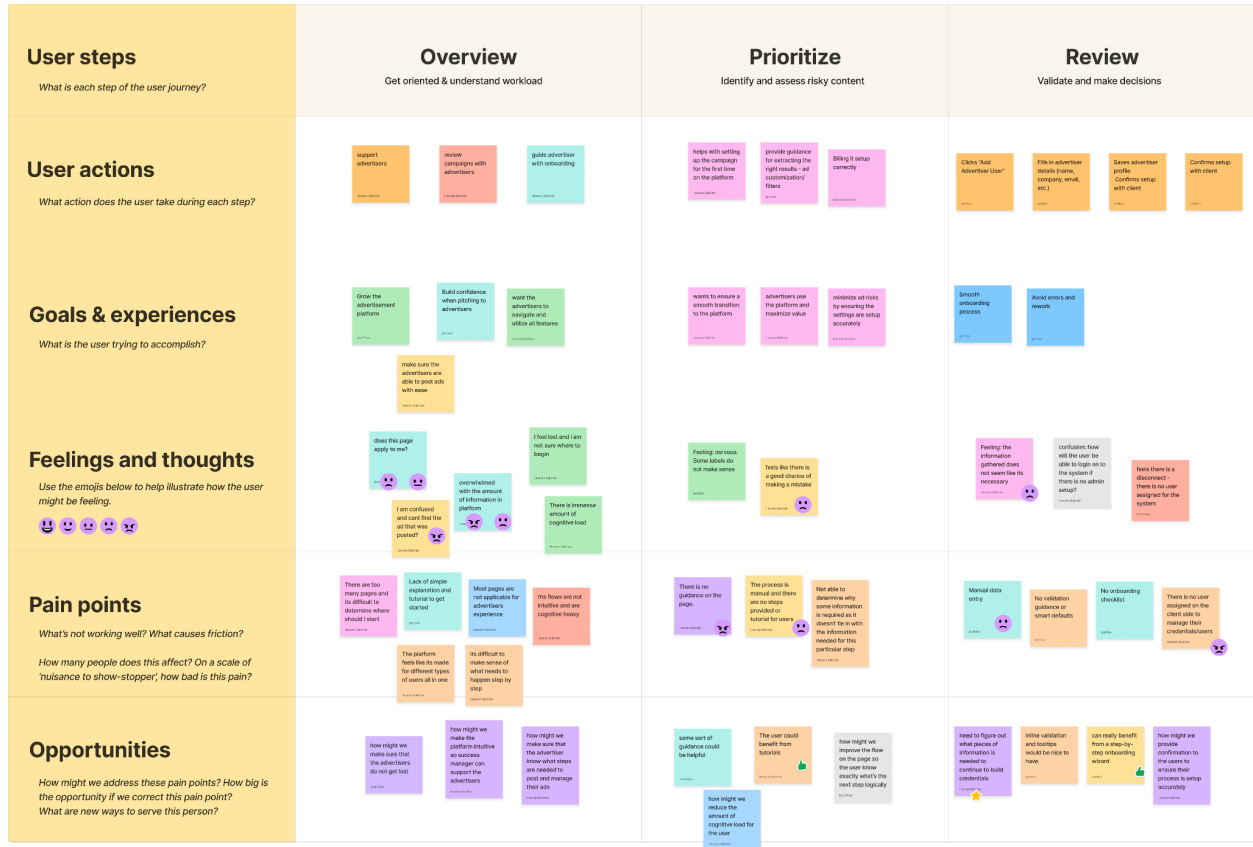


Figure 4.6 User Journey Flow – Jane -2

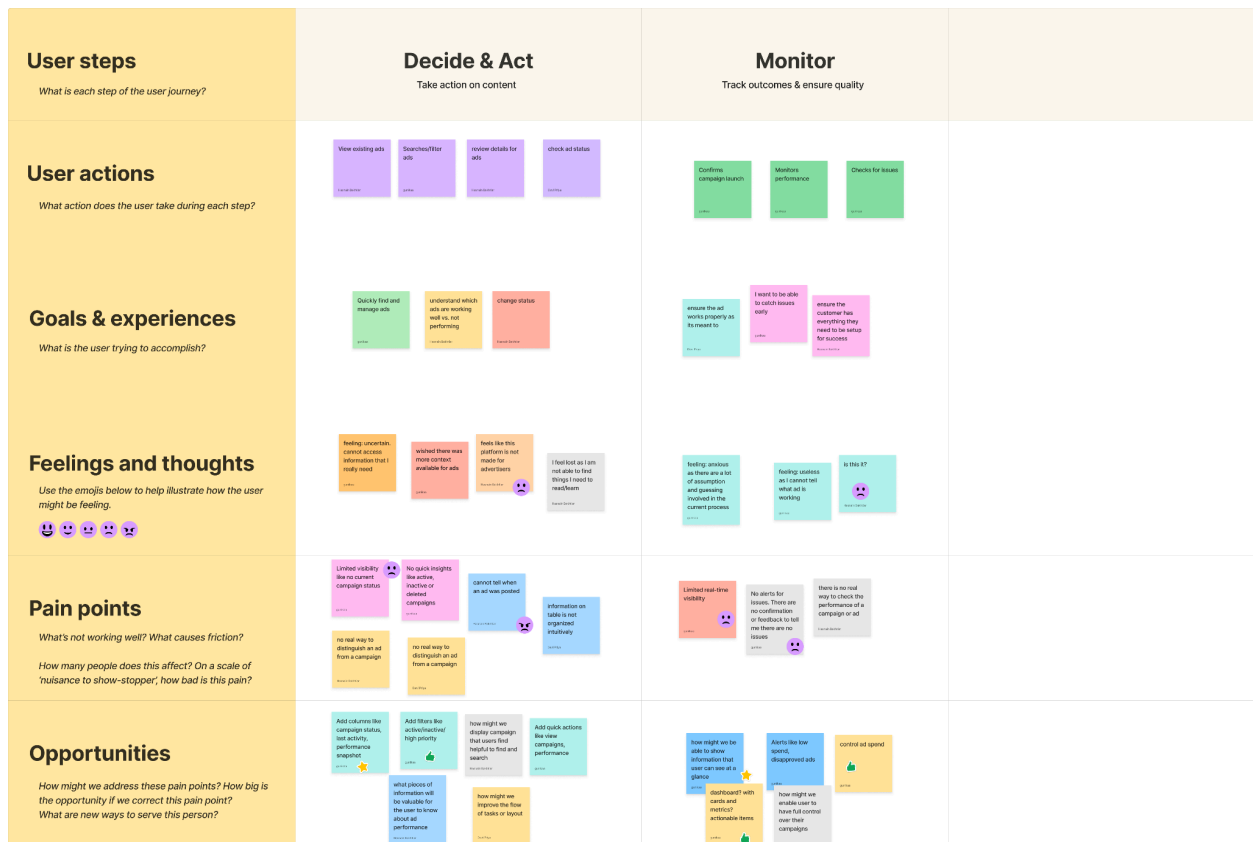


Figure 4.6 User Journey Flow – Jane -3

4.3 Low-Fidelity Prototyping

After conducting initial usability testing with the low-fidelity prototypes, identified several critical usability issues. Most notably:

- **Redesign of information hierarchy and data visibility** to better present key metrics and improve overall clarity of the dashboard.
- **Enhancement of teen safety mechanisms**, including identity verification processes and more efficient handling of harmful or inappropriate content.
- **Improvement of advertising management features** to better support advertisers in campaign setup and performance monitoring.
- **Introduction of information preview functions**, allowing users to quickly access relevant details without navigating away from the main workflow.
- **Prioritization of actions through urgency-based categorization** helps users identify and respond to critical tasks more efficiently.
- **Increased flexibility and control**, enabling administrators to filter and customize views across different sections of the dashboard.

I began by using the initial dashboard screenshots provided by Tami and leveraging AI tools to quickly convert them into editable design components. This allowed us to build and iterate on early prototypes efficiently.

Through discussions, workshops, and the development of personas and user journey maps, progressively gained a deeper understanding of user needs and behaviors. These insights were then translated into more refined design decisions, enabling us to better represent and address the requirements of different user roles within the system.

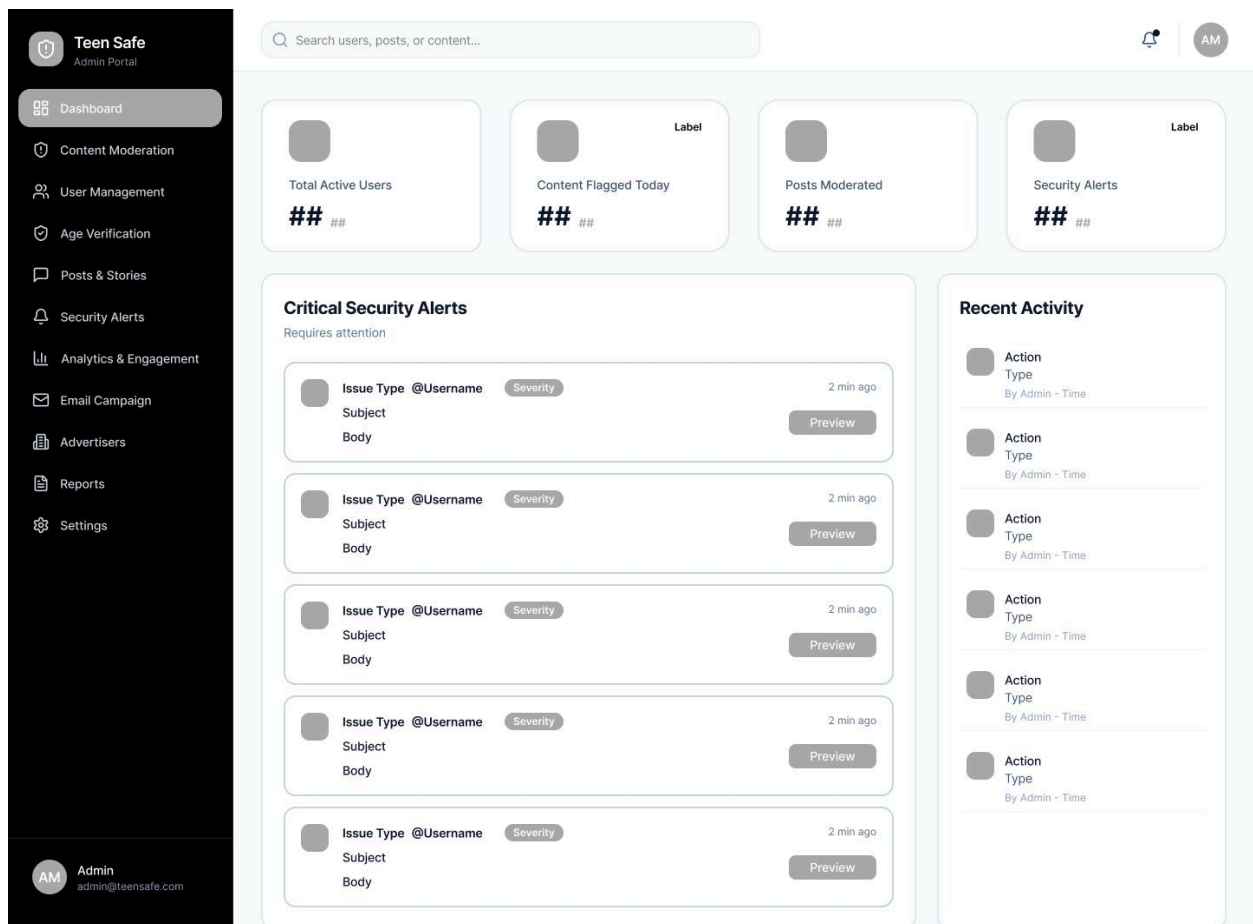


Figure 4.7 Lo-Fi Wireframe – Dashboard Page

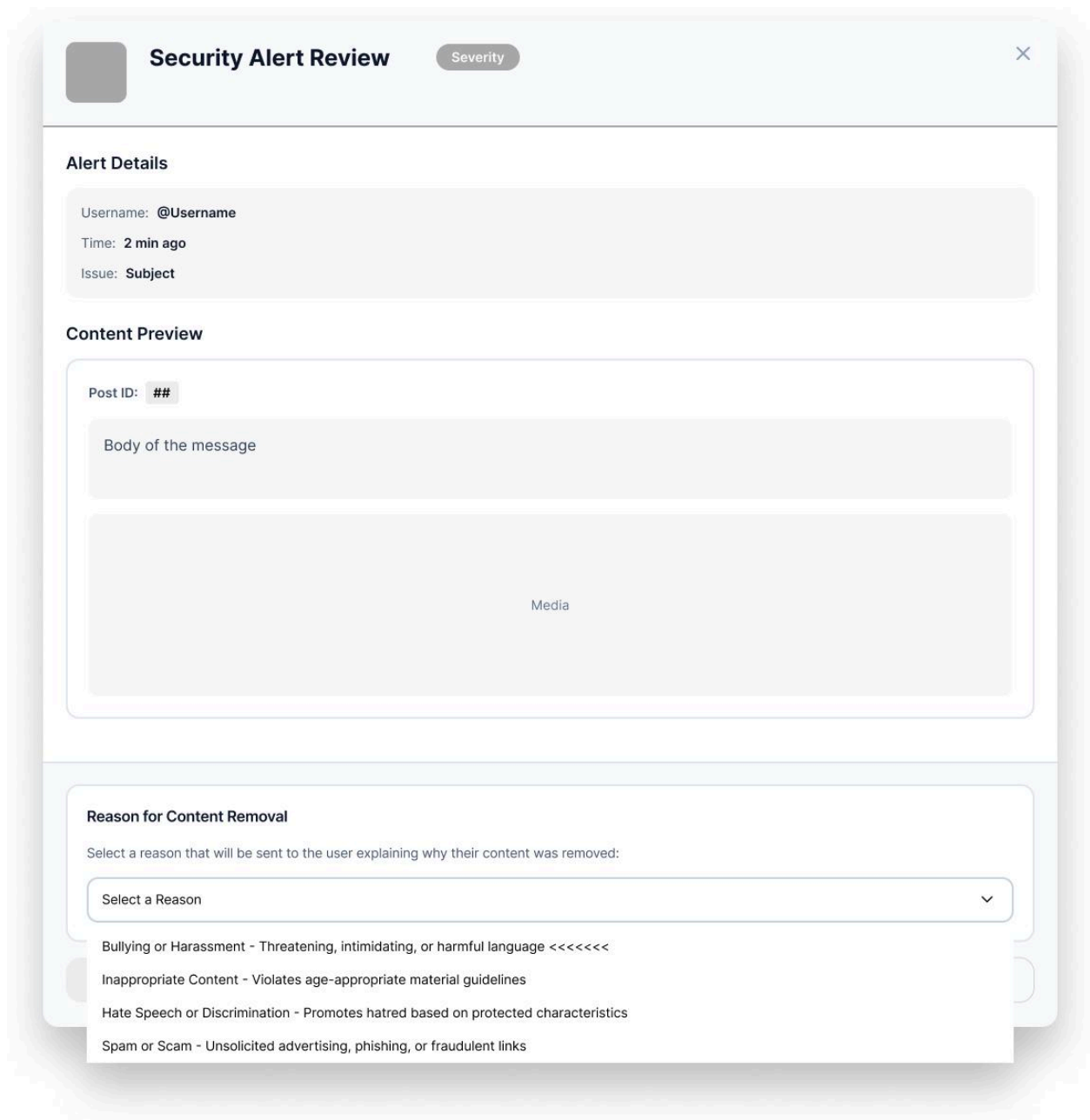


Figure 4.8 Lo-Fi Wireframe – Security

4.4 High-fidelity Prototyping

After the low-fidelity prototyping stage, the design was further developed into high-fidelity mockups to deliver a more polished, realistic, and production-ready user experience. The high-fidelity prototypes focused on improving visual clarity, interaction flow, content organization, and overall usability across the admin dashboard and the advertising management portal.

The refined dashboard design introduced a clearer information hierarchy, enabling administrators to quickly understand key platform metrics, moderation priorities, user activity, and urgent safety-related tasks. Key information, such as reported content, flagged teen accounts, verification status, campaign performance, and moderation alerts, was made more visible and easier to access.

A major focus of the high-fidelity design was teen safety. The prototype included improved workflows for identity verification, content moderation, harmful content review, and urgent issue handling. Actions were categorized by urgency, helping moderators identify high-priority cases and respond more efficiently. This ensured that safety-related decisions could be made more quickly and accurately.

The advertising management portal was also developed as part of the high-fidelity prototype. It was designed to help advertisers set up campaigns, view campaign performance, manage ad content, and understand approval status. The design emphasized transparency, ease of use, and responsible advertising on a teen-focused platform.

To improve workflow efficiency, preview functions were added to key sections of the dashboard. These previews let users quickly view key details without leaving the current page, reducing unnecessary navigation and enabling faster decision-making. Filtering and customization features were also included to give administrators greater flexibility and control when managing users, content, reports, and advertising data.

The final high-fidelity prototypes adopted a more consistent visual language, with improved spacing, typography, color, icons, cards, tables, and navigation patterns. These refinements helped create a professional, intuitive, and scalable interface that better supports the needs of moderators, platform managers, and advertisers.

4.4.1 Clear Information Hierarchy in Dashboard Design

The refined dashboard design introduced a clearer, more structured information hierarchy, improving usability and decision-making efficiency. Key platform data, including user activity, alerts, moderation tasks, and campaign performance, was reorganized into prioritized sections based on importance and urgency.

This redesign addressed issues identified in earlier stages, where information was scattered and lacked clear structure, increasing cognitive load for administrators. By improving data visibility and grouping related functions, users can now quickly understand system status and identify critical tasks.

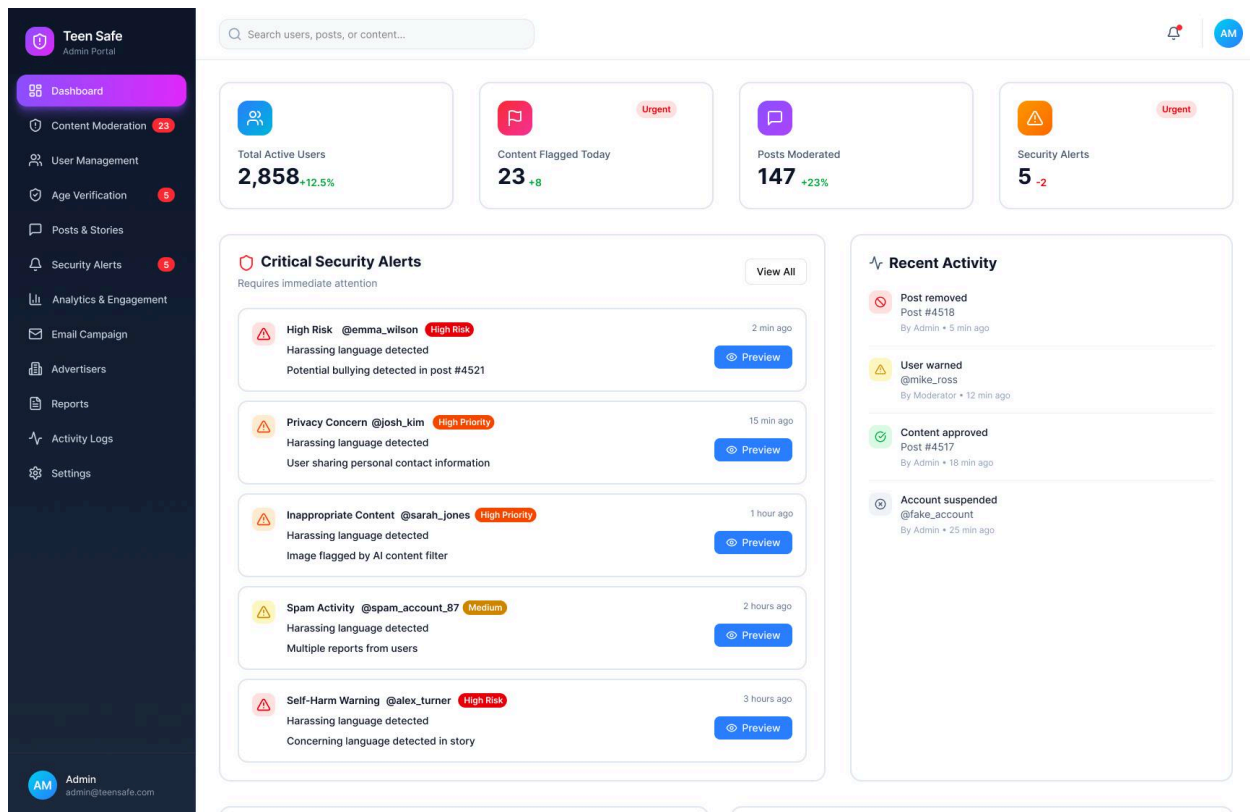


Figure 4.9 High-fidelity Prototyping – Clear Information Hierarchy in Dashboard Design

4.4.2 Teen Safety - Identity Verification

A dedicated identity verification workflow was introduced to ensure that users meet age requirements and comply with platform policies. The system allows administrators to review verification requests, verify user information, and efficiently approve or reject accounts.

This feature addresses the need for stronger governance mechanisms identified in both the literature and the workshop findings. It helps ensure underage users are protected while maintaining a safer, more controlled platform environment.

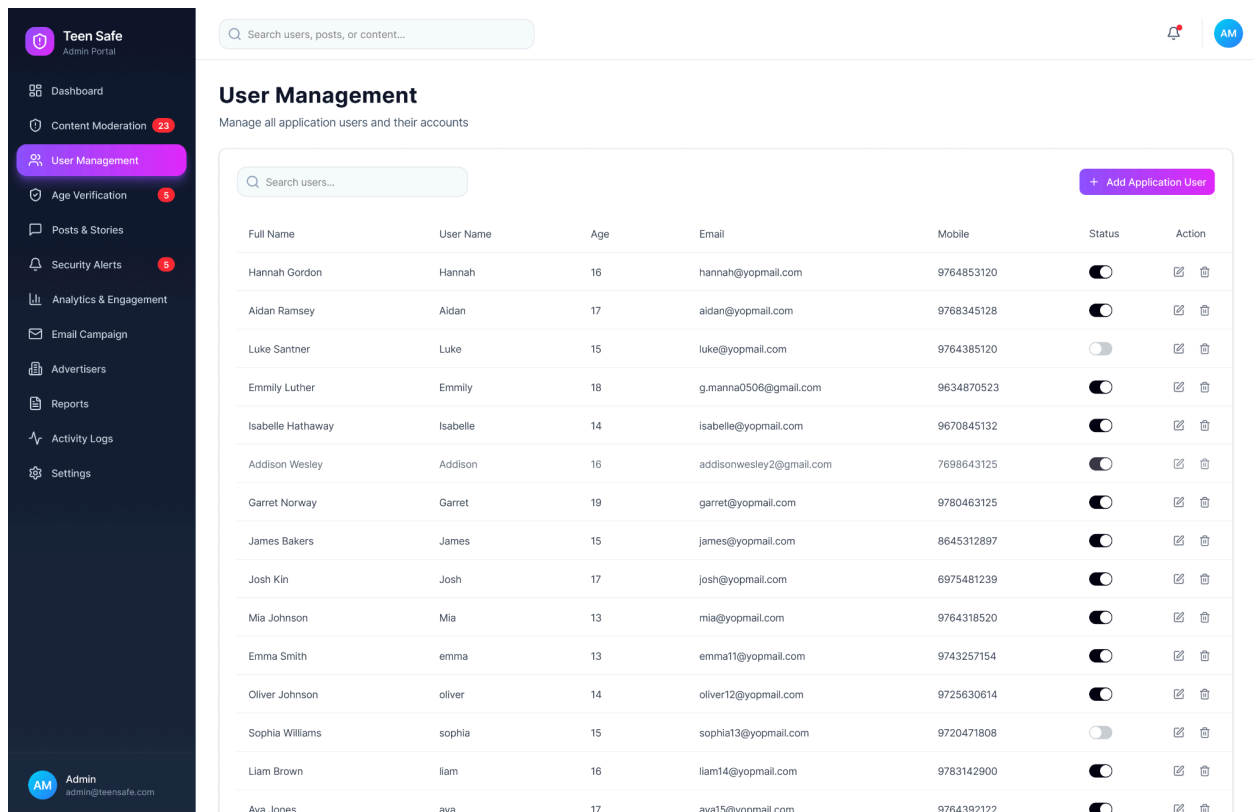


Figure 4.10 High-fidelity Prototyping – User Management

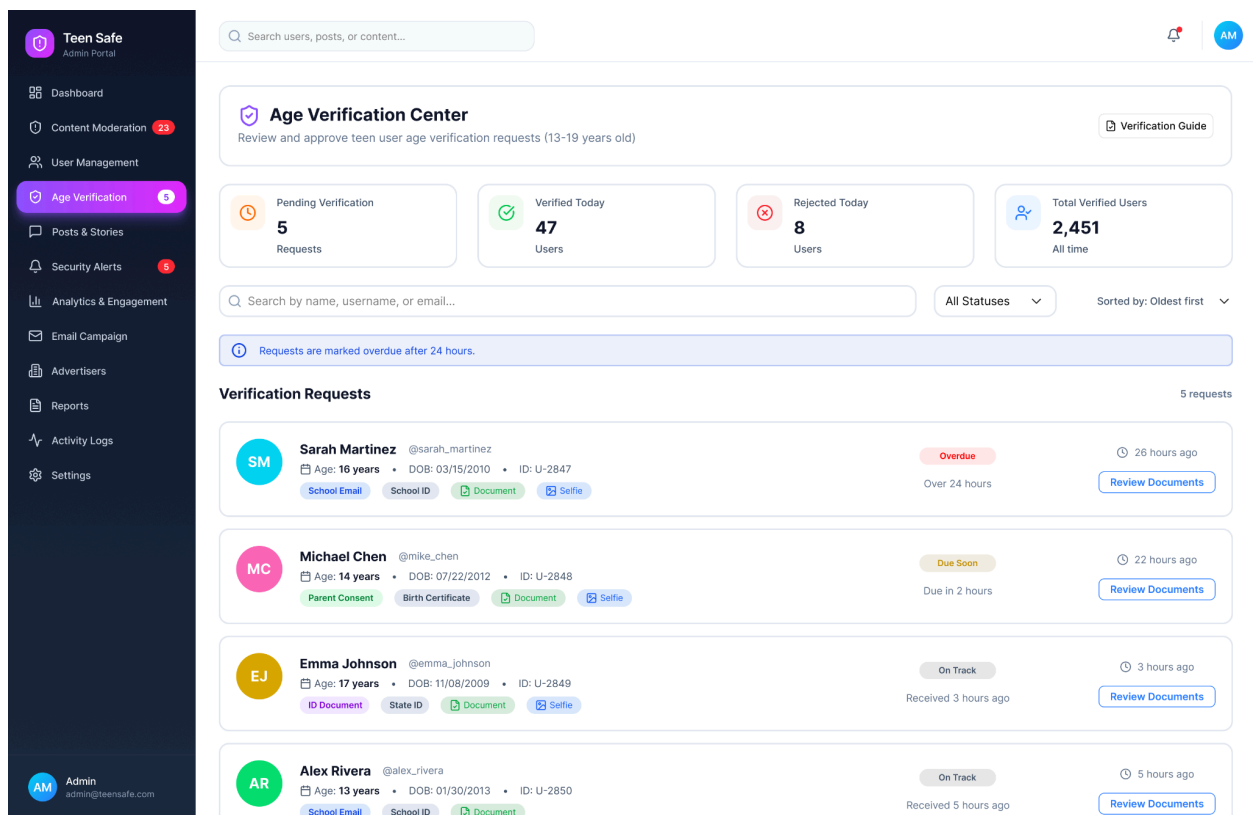


Figure 4.11 High-fidelity Prototyping – Age Verification

4.4.3 Teen Safety - Content Moderation and Emergency Handling

The high-fidelity design includes improved workflows for content moderation, harmful content review, and urgent issue handling. Moderation tasks are categorized by urgency, allowing administrators to prioritize high-risk cases, such as inappropriate content or safety threats.

Additionally, the system provides clearer context during review, such as content previews and policy references, helping moderators make more informed decisions. This directly addresses the challenges of high workload, unclear policies, and a lack of contextual information identified in earlier stages.

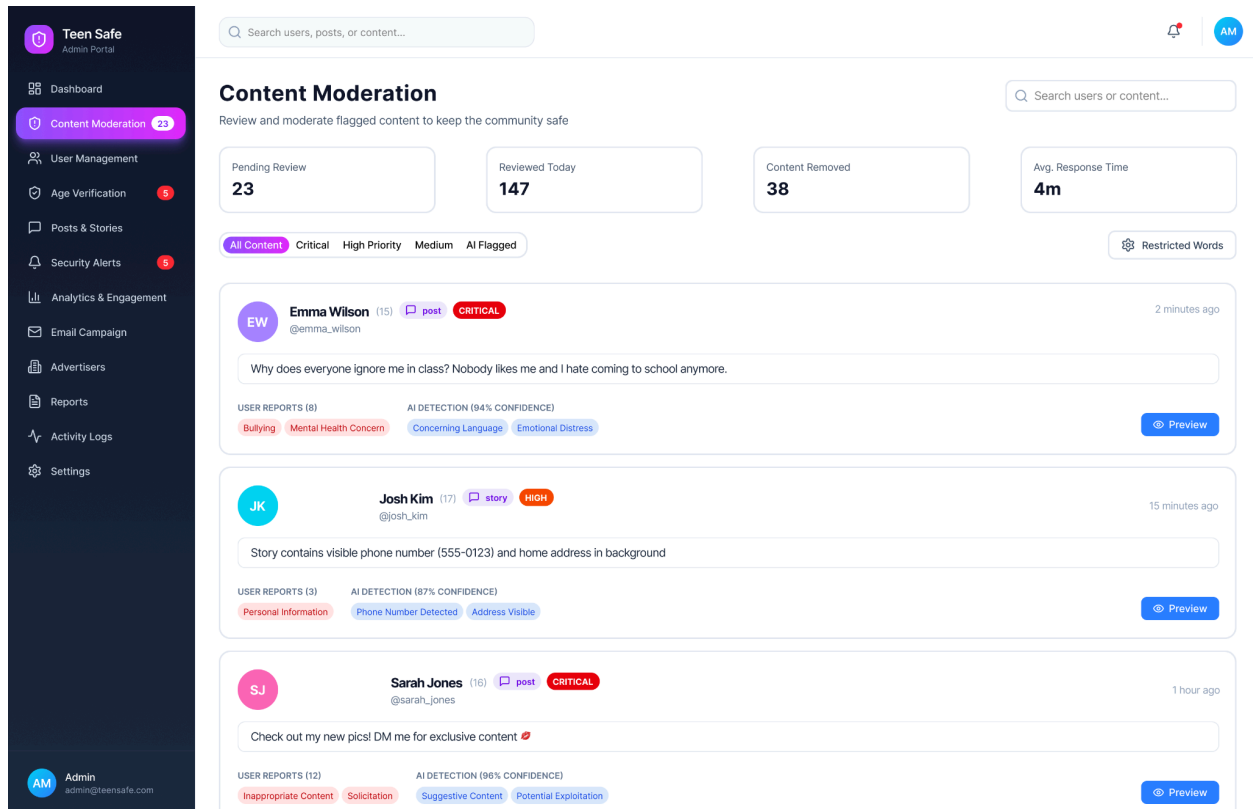


Figure 4.12 High-fidelity Prototyping - Content Moderation

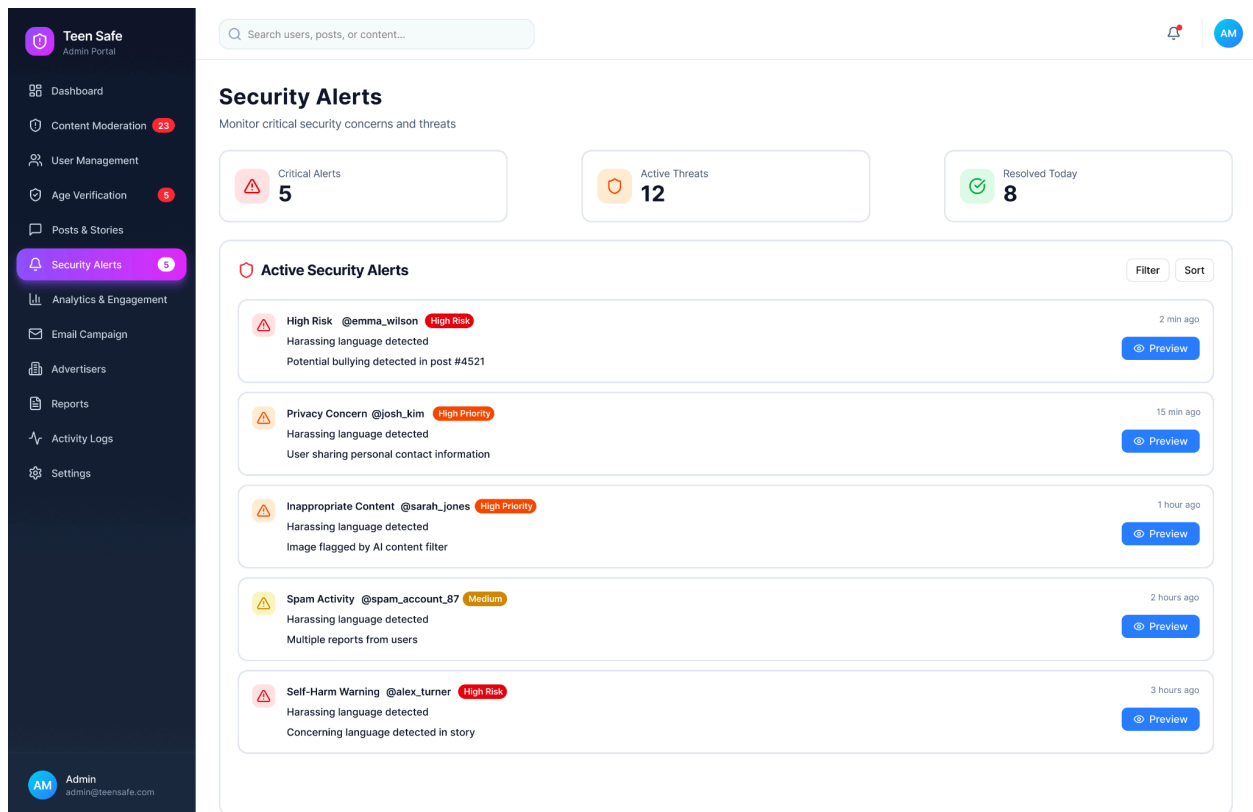


Figure 4.13 High-fidelity Prototyping – Security Alerts

4.4.4 Preview Function

Preview functions were integrated into the moderation workflow, allowing administrators to quickly view the full content of teenage user posts without leaving the main dashboard. This includes text, images, and other relevant context for flagged or reported content.

This feature enables more efficient and informed decision-making during the review process. Rather than switching between multiple pages, moderators can assess content directly within their workflow, reducing time spent and cognitive load.

It also addresses key challenges identified in earlier stages, such as limited context and a heavy workload during content moderation. By providing immediate access to content details, the system enables faster responses to potentially harmful or inappropriate posts, improving both efficiency and platform safety.

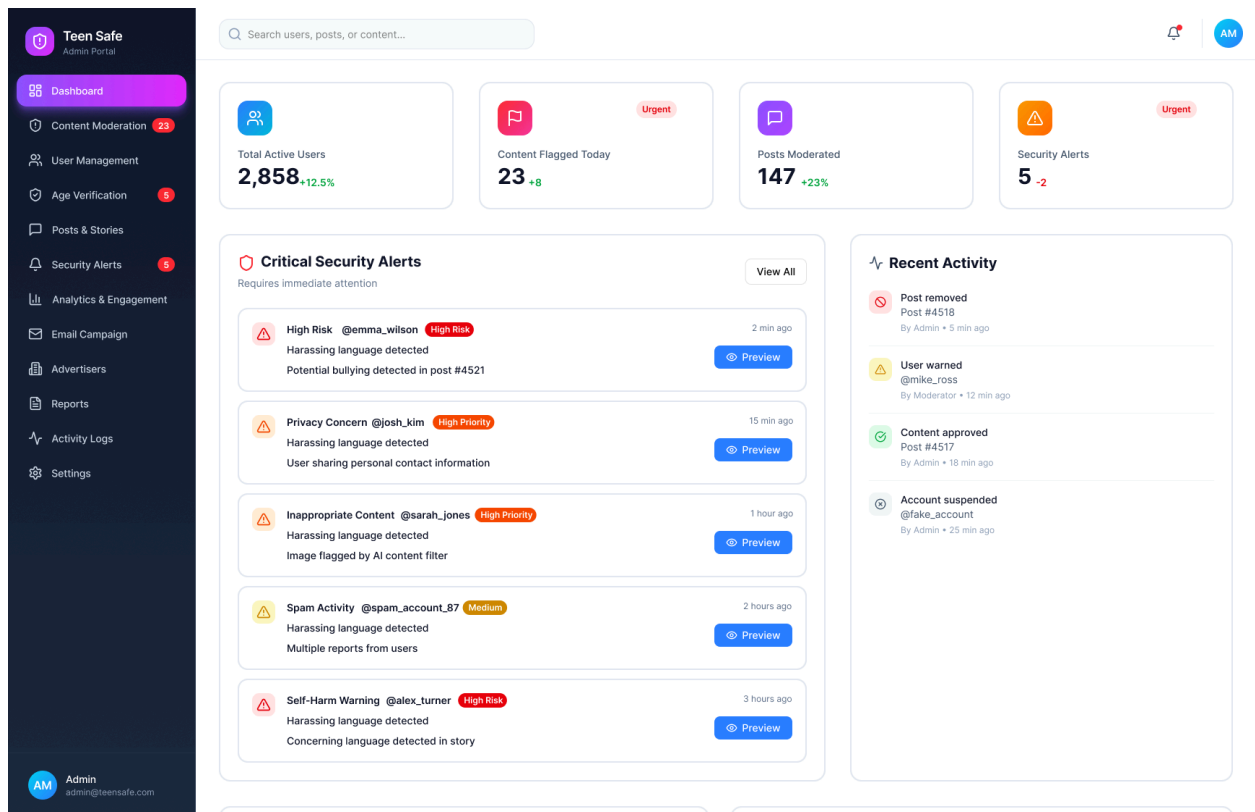


Figure 4.14 High-fidelity Prototyping – Security Alerts - Click the eye icon to preview

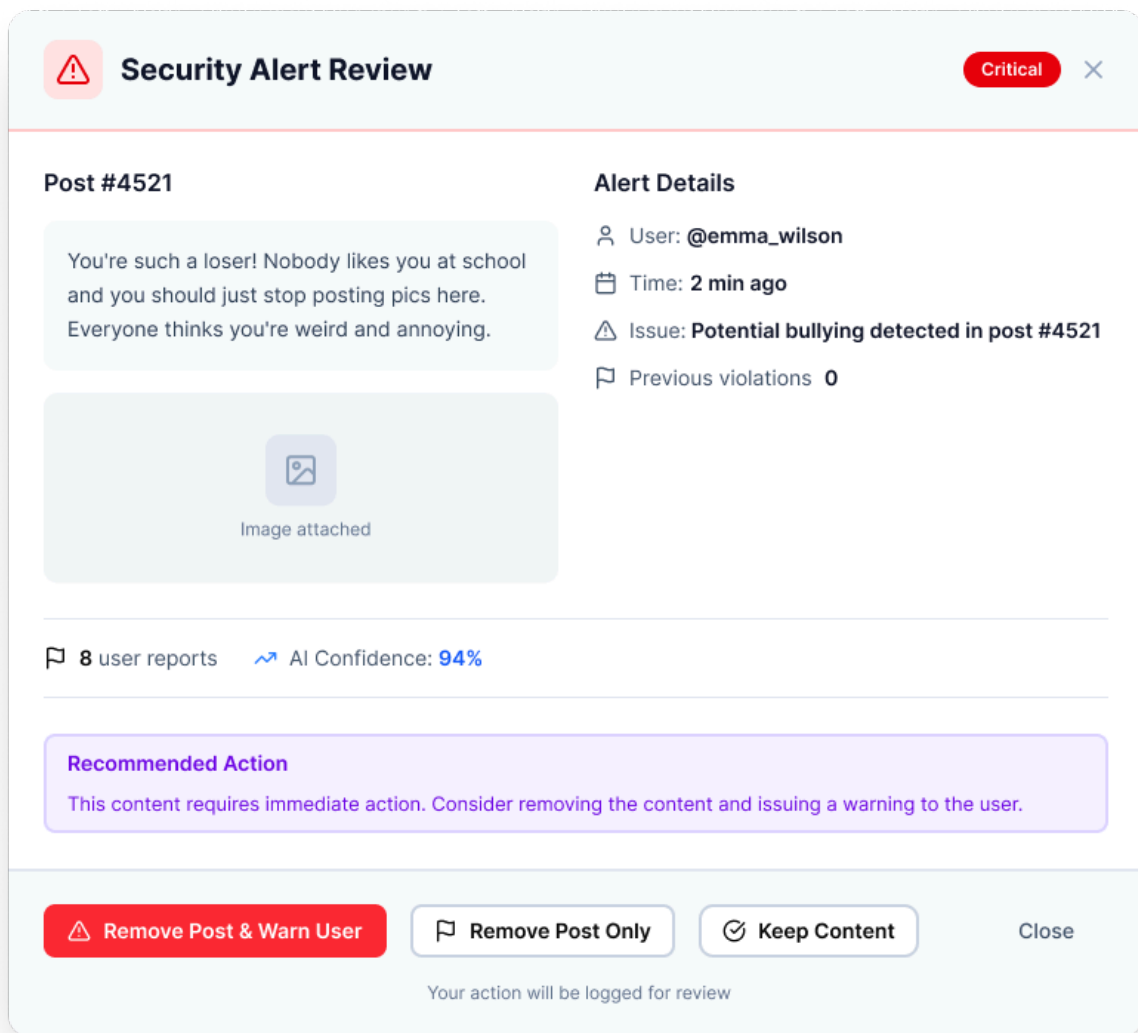


Figure 4.15 High-fidelity Prototyping – Security Alerts Review

4.4.5 Advertising Management Platform

A structured advertising management portal was developed to help external advertisers create, manage, and monitor campaigns. The platform includes features such as campaign creation, audience targeting (age, gender, interests), budget control, and performance tracking.

This design addresses the lack of advertiser support identified in the original system. It also aligns with research findings that underscore the importance of targeted advertising and the need for transparent, easy-to-use campaign management tools.

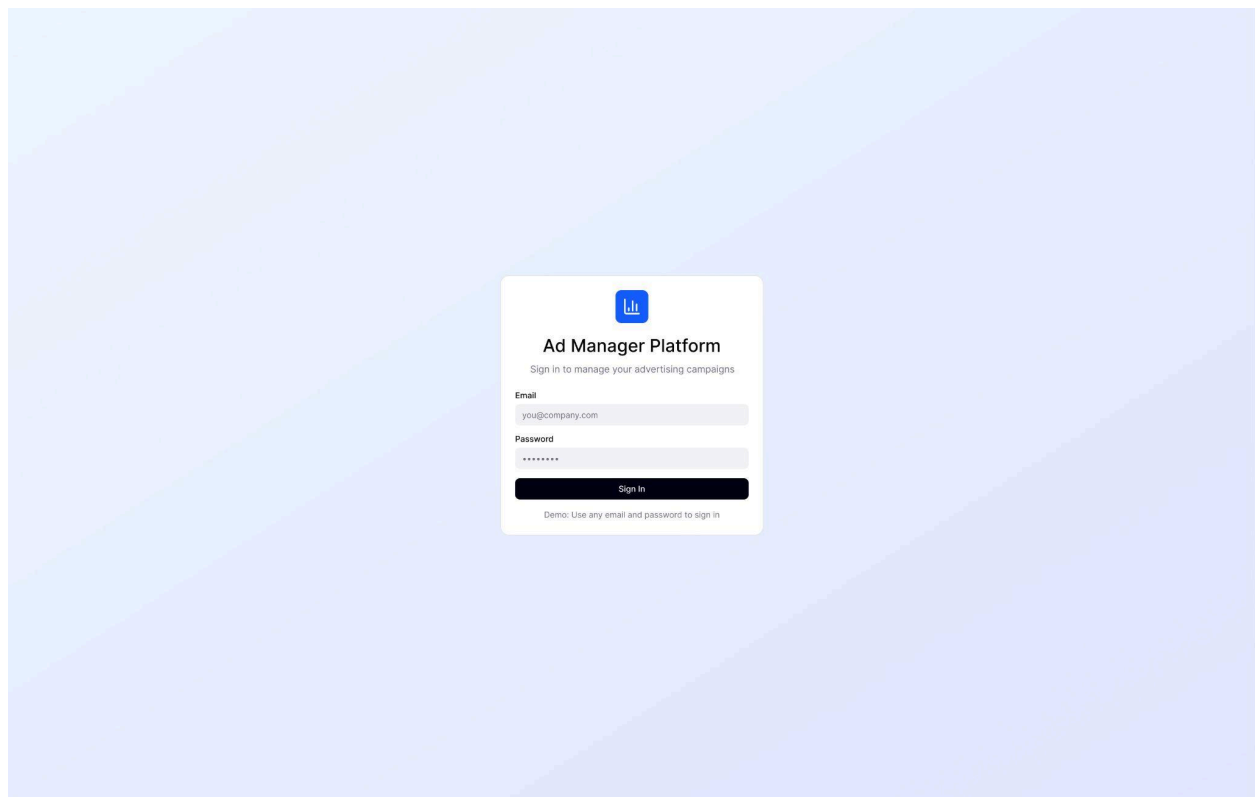


Figure 4.16 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Platform Sign In Page

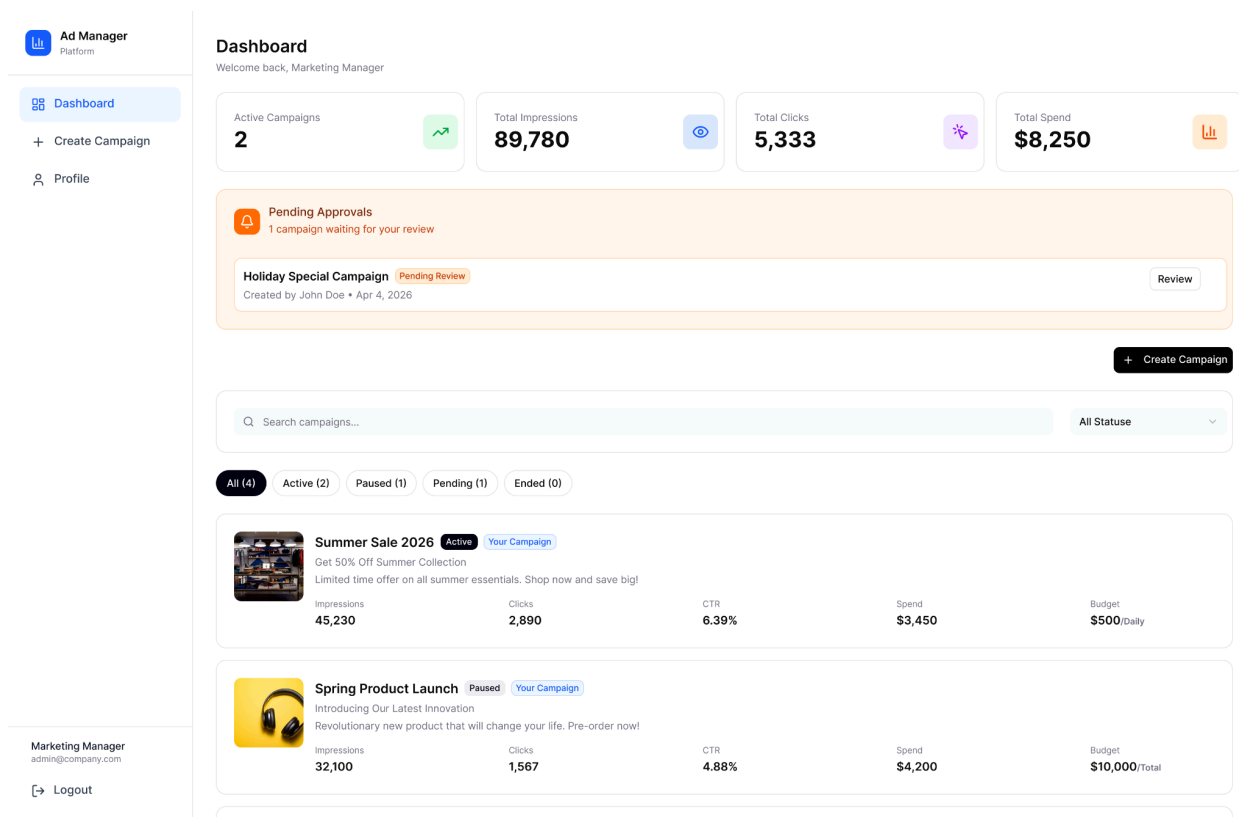


Figure 4.17 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Platform Dashboard

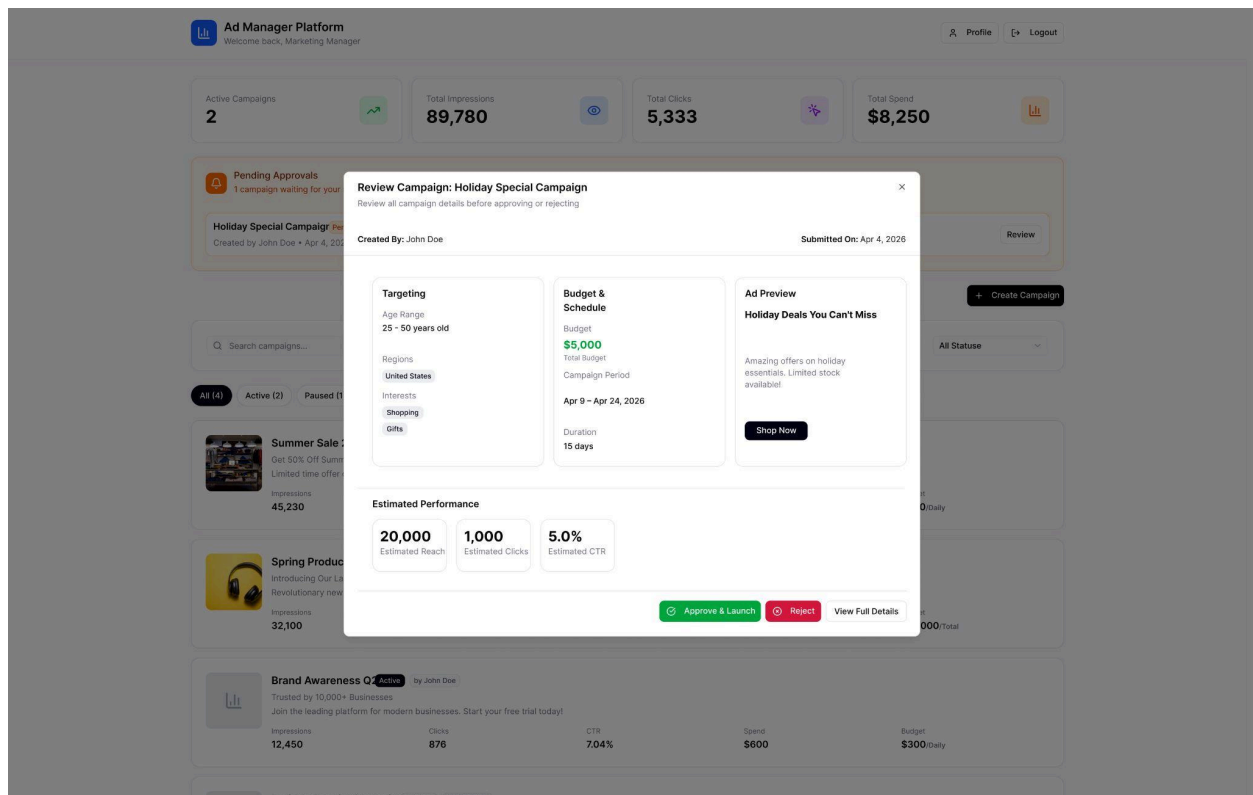


Figure 4.18 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Payment & Target Audience Setting

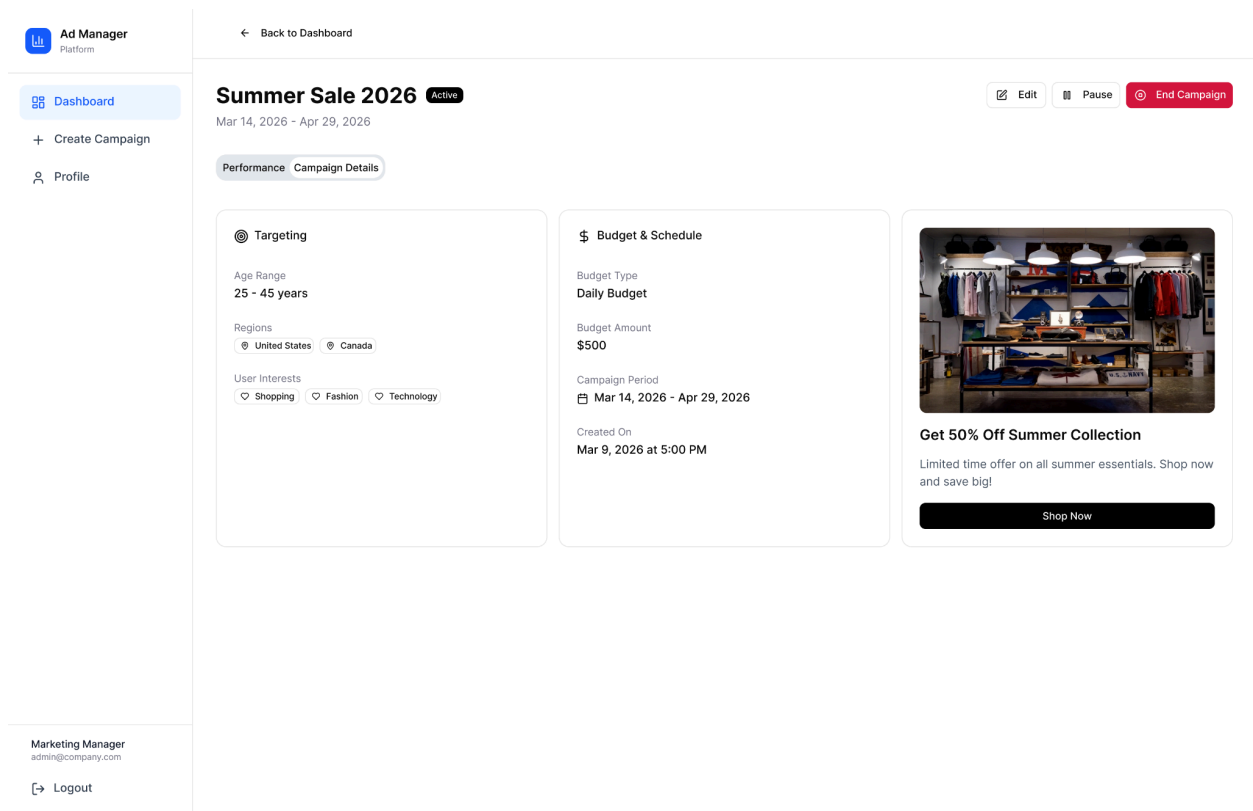


Figure 4.19 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Data Analysis

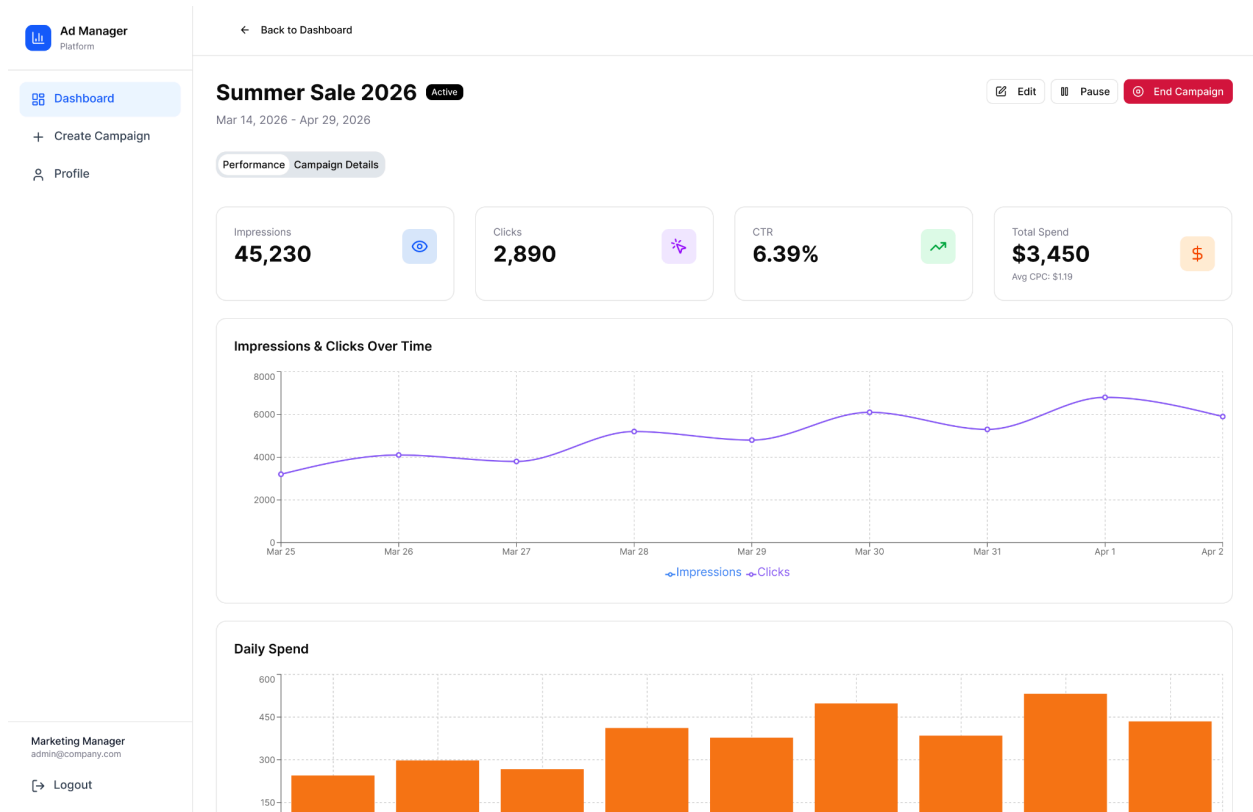


Figure 4.20 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Data Analysis

Create New Campaign

Campaign Details

Campaign Name

e.g., Summer Sale 2026

Audience Targeting

Age Range: 18 - 65 years

Regions (0 selected)

☐ United States

☐ United Kingdom

☐ Germany

☐ Italy

☐ New Zealand

☐ Singapore

☐ Brazil

☐ Canada

☐ France

☐ Spain

☐ Australia

☐ Japan

☐ India

☐ Mexico

User Interests (0 selected)

☐ Technology

☐ Shopping

☐ Travel

☐ Entertainment

☐ Finance

☐ Education

☐ Music

☐ Automotive

☐ Fashion

☐ Sports

☐ Food & Dining

☐ Business

☐ Health & Fitness

☐ Gaming

☐ Art & Design

☐ Real Estate

Budget Settings

☒ Daily Budget

☐ Total Budget

Daily Budget (\$)

e.g., 500

Campaign Schedule

Start Date

Pick a date

End Date

Pick a date

Ad Creative

Media Upload


Click to upload image

Headline

e.g., Get 50% Off Summer Collection

Ad Text

Describe your offer...

Call to Action

Shop Now

Cancel

Figure 4.21 High-fidelity Prototyping – Ad Manager Ad Setting

4.5. Conclusion

The Teen Safe project focused on designing a structured, user-centered admin dashboard and an advertising management portal for a teen-focused social platform. The existing platform lacked clear administrative tools, moderation workflows, and advertiser-facing systems, making it difficult to manage user safety, platform activity, and campaign operations.

Through research, heuristic evaluation, persona development, user journey mapping, and low- and high-fidelity prototyping, the project identified key usability and workflow issues. These included an unclear information hierarchy, limited data visibility, inefficient moderation processes, insufficient advertiser support, and a need for stronger teen safety mechanisms.

The final design solution addressed these issues by delivering a more organized, intuitive, and visually consistent dashboard experience. The redesigned admin dashboard enables faster decision-making, clearer moderation actions, improved content review, stronger identity verification, and greater control over platform operations. The advertising portal gives businesses a structured way to manage campaigns, monitor performance, and interact with the platform responsibly.

Overall, the project improved the usability, safety, and scalability of Teen Social's administrative ecosystem. By focusing on the needs of moderators, platform managers, advertisers, and teen users, the final design provides a stronger foundation for safe community management, responsible advertising, and sustainable platform growth.

5. Usability Testing Plane

5.1 Usability Testing Implementation

5.1.1 Purpose

The usability testing aimed to evaluate how effectively the Teen Safe Admin Dashboard supports key user tasks across different stakeholder roles, including moderation admins, digital ad managers, and platform success managers.

The goal was to:

- Identify usability issues
- Validate design decisions
- Assess whether the interface improves efficiency, clarity, and user confidence

5.1.2 Methodology

A task-based usability testing approach was conducted using interactive high-fidelity prototypes. Participants were assigned realistic scenarios aligned with the three personas (Jordan, Emily, and Jane).

Testing sessions focused on observing how users interact with the system while completing core tasks such as:

- content moderation
- identity verification
- campaign management
- user support

Participants were encouraged to think aloud during the session, allowing the team to capture insights into their decision-making process and pain points.

5.1.3 Participants

A small group of **3–5 participants** was recruited to represent the three primary personas:

- Moderation Admin (Jordan)
- Digital Ad Manager (Emily)
- Ad Platform Success Manager (Jane)

Participants had prior experience or familiarity with:

- social media platforms
- content moderation tools
- digital advertising dashboards

5.1.4 Tasks and Scenarios

Based on the persona-driven testing framework, three main scenarios were developed:

Scenario 1: Moderation Admin (Jordan)

Situation:

You are responsible for reviewing flagged content and ensuring platform safety.

Tasks:

- Identify high-risk flagged content from the dashboard
- Use the preview function to review a post
- Decide whether to approve, reject, or escalate content
- Check user identity verification status

Focus:

- Can users prioritize tasks efficiently?
- Do they have enough context to make decisions?

Scenario 2: Digital Ad Manager (Emily)

Situation:

You want to manage and optimize your advertising campaigns.

Tasks:

- Review campaign performance data
- Identify underperforming campaigns
- Adjust targeting (age, gender, interests)
- Check campaign status (draft / active / in review)

Focus:

- Is the data clear and understandable?
- Can users make decisions quickly?

Scenario 3: Platform Success Manager (Jane)

Situation:

You are supporting advertisers in setting up campaigns and understanding the platform.

Tasks:

- Guide a new advertiser through campaign setup
- Review campaign configuration
- Help troubleshoot issues
- Monitor campaign progress

Focus:

- Is the system intuitive for onboarding?
- Does the interface support guidance and support tasks?

5.1.5 Data Collection Methods

Both qualitative and quantitative data were collected:

- **Qualitative:**
 - Think-aloud feedback
 - Observations of user behavior
 - Post-task interviews
- **Quantitative:**
 - Task completion rate
 - Time on task
 - Error frequency
- **Post-test feedback:** Participants completed a short survey evaluating
 - Usability (ease of use)
 - Clarity (understanding of the system)
 - Perceived value (usefulness)
 - Trust (confidence in system)
 - Motivation (willingness to continue use)

5.1.6 Key Evaluation Criteria

The evaluation focused on the following criteria:

- **Efficiency:** How quickly users complete tasks
- **Effectiveness:** Accuracy and success rate of task completion
- **Learnability:** Ease of understanding the interface for new users
- **Satisfaction:** User confidence and perceived usability

5.1.7 Findings and Insights

Usability testing is expected to yield valuable insights into how effectively the dashboard supports different user roles and tasks. The findings will help identify both strengths and areas for improvement in the current design.

Specifically, the testing is expected to provide answers to the following:

- **Effectiveness of task prioritization:** Whether users can easily identify and prioritize critical tasks, such as flagged content and urgent safety issues, within the dashboard.
- **Clarity of information and data presentation:** Whether key information, such as user activity, alerts, and campaign performance, is presented clearly and can be quickly understood.

- **Support for decision-making in moderation tasks:** Whether features such as content previews, contextual information, and policy references provide sufficient support for accurate, confident decision-making.
- **Usability of the advertising management workflow:** Whether advertisers can efficiently create, manage, and monitor campaigns without confusion or unnecessary complexity.
- **Learnability and onboarding experience:** Whether new users can understand how to navigate the system and complete tasks with minimal guidance.
- **User confidence and trust in the system:** Whether users feel confident using the platform, particularly in areas related to moderation decisions and data reliability.
- **Overall user satisfaction and efficiency:** Whether the redesigned system improves workflow efficiency, reduces cognitive load, and enhances the overall user experience.

6. Next Steps & Strategic Suggestions

6.1. Suggestion

Based on the findings from the research, design iterations, and usability testing, the following next steps are recommended to further enhance the Teen Safe Admin Dashboard and Ad Management Portal:

- **Conduct iterative usability testing with a larger user group:** expand testing beyond the initial 3–5 participants to validate design decisions across a more diverse set of user profiles and identify additional usability issues.
- **Refine moderation tools with AI-assisted features:** Introduce intelligent support, including automated content flagging, risk scoring, and decision suggestions, to reduce moderator workload and improve consistency.
- **Enhance data transparency and analytics for advertisers:** Provide clearer performance metrics, audience insights, and real-time feedback to support better decision-making and increase advertiser trust.
- **Strengthen teen safety and compliance mechanisms:** Further develop identity verification, content filtering, and policy enforcement systems to ensure a safer, age-appropriate environment.
- **Develop a scalable design system:** Establish consistent UI components, interaction patterns, and guidelines to support future expansion and ensure design consistency across the platform.
- **Enhance onboarding and guidance features:** Introduce tooltips, tutorials, and contextual help to reduce reliance on support teams and improve learnability for new users.

6.2 Conclusion

This project demonstrates how a user-centered design approach can effectively transform an initial concept into a structured, usable, and scalable admin dashboard and advertising management system.

By integrating insights from research, personas, journey mapping, and usability testing, the proposed solution addresses key challenges in usability, safety, and business needs.

Moving forward, continued iteration, validation, and integration of advanced features will be essential to ensure the platform remains efficient, trustworthy, and capable of supporting internal operations and external stakeholders.

7. Hardware

The proposed system is designed to be compatible with standard computing devices used by administrators and advertisers.

- Desktop and laptop computers (Windows / macOS)
- Mobile devices (iOS / Android) for preview and testing purposes
- Standard input devices such as the keyboard and mouse

The system does not require specialized hardware and is intended to be accessible via common web-based environments.

8. Software

The proposed system can be developed and supported with common web technologies and design tools.

- Frontend: Web-based interface (e.g., React, HTML, CSS)
- Backend (conceptual): Database and server-side logic for managing users, content, and campaigns
- Design tools: Figma for prototyping and interface design
- Testing tools: Usability testing platforms and survey tools

These technologies support scalability, accessibility, and efficient system development.

9. Appendix

The appendix includes supporting materials that informed the research phase, design process, and final solution.

These artifacts provide additional context, detailed information, and visual references for the work presented in this report.

[Workshop Artifacts \(Figjam\)](#)

[Literature Review Google Doc.](#)

[Design Exploration \(Figma\)](#)

[User Personas \(Figjam\)](#)

[User Journey Maps \(Figjam\)](#)

[Low-Fidelity Prototyping](#)

[High-Fidelity Prototype](#)